

# POV: You Still Live With Your Parents at 30



— *While Everyone Else Pays Someone Else's Mortgage*

**18**

CHARACTERS

**288**

BEATS

**11**

STAGES

**~24 min**

RUNTIME

Interactive: tap any link to jump, tick the boxes, type notes. Use your PDF app's bookmarks panel to navigate.

Best in Adobe Acrobat Reader, Foxit, Xodo or a desktop browser so the boxes and notes save.

# How to use this book

This book works in **two steps**. Every blue word is a link: tap it to jump. The dark bar at the top of every page has **Stage overview** and **Cast** buttons, and your PDF app's **bookmarks panel** lists every stage and character.

**STEP 1 · Build your cast.** Generate one reference image for each character using the [character prompts](#). Save the images and tick **Reference made**. Attach these references when generating beats so faces stay consistent.

**STEP 2 · Generate the beats.** Work stage by stage from the [stage overview](#). Each beat is about **5 seconds** of narration (one image on screen). Copy the image prompt, generate, and tick **Image**, **Animated** and **Placed** as you go. Use the notes box at the start of each stage for anything you want to remember.

**In the edit:** drop each image at its timecode, or simply set every image to 5 seconds. The beats average 5.0s, so the timeline stays in sync with the voiceover. Add a slow push-in or pan to every image.

## Locked visual style

flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail.

## Outfit and lighting by stage

| STAGES                    | OUTFIT                                     | LIGHTING                                                                                       |
|---------------------------|--------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 & 10 · Rooftop (age 30) | Black quarter-zip                          | warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline |
| 2-4 · Ages 22-24          | Black hoodie, hood up, younger and thinner | flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones                                               |
| 5-7 · Ages 25-27          | Black crewneck sweater                     | soft clean daylight, neutral tones                                                             |
| 8-9 · Ages 28-29          | Black quarter-zip                          | soft warm daylight, gentle shadows                                                             |
| 11 · Moving out           | Black quarter-zip                          | warm natural light with amber accents                                                          |
| Bedroom at night          | Any                                        | dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars                 |

## Recurring visual motifs

31 glow-in-the-dark plastic stars on the bedroom ceiling · the spare key on a faded blue high-school lanyard · the \$800 envelopes · the circled “22 payments left” · the porch light · the heated rooftop pool · Theo and Jenna's red front door · Marcus's linen shirt and watch

STEP 1 OF 2

Build your cast

Generate these reference images before any beat.

18 characters  
Tick each one when its reference is saved

| CHARACTER                 | ROLE                                   | APPEARS IN |                                         |
|---------------------------|----------------------------------------|------------|-----------------------------------------|
| The Protagonist           | Adult · ages 25–30 · main character    | 107 beats  | <input type="checkbox"/> Reference made |
| The Protagonist (younger) | Age 22–24 · flashbacks and early years | 36 beats   | <input type="checkbox"/> Reference made |
| Marcus                    | Friend · flashy renter downtown        | 41 beats   | <input type="checkbox"/> Reference made |
| Theo                      | Friend · homeowner with the red door   | 34 beats   | <input type="checkbox"/> Reference made |
| Jenna                     | Friend · Theo's wife                   | 31 beats   | <input type="checkbox"/> Reference made |
| Priya                     | Friend · the one who notices           | 35 beats   | <input type="checkbox"/> Reference made |
| Mother                    | His mother                             | 26 beats   | <input type="checkbox"/> Reference made |
| Father                    | His father                             | 22 beats   | <input type="checkbox"/> Reference made |
| Alana                     | The date                               | 6 beats    | <input type="checkbox"/> Reference made |
| Greg                      | His manager                            | 6 beats    | <input type="checkbox"/> Reference made |
| Aunt Denise               | Thanksgiving relative                  | 2 beats    | <input type="checkbox"/> Reference made |
| Cousin Kyle               | Thanksgiving relative                  | 5 beats    | <input type="checkbox"/> Reference made |
| The Uncle                 | Thanksgiving relative                  | 1 beats    | <input type="checkbox"/> Reference made |
| The Leasing Agent         | Downtown loft                          | 5 beats    | <input type="checkbox"/> Reference made |
| The Mechanic              | Repair shop                            | 2 beats    | <input type="checkbox"/> Reference made |
| The Loan Officer          | The house purchase                     | 4 beats    | <input type="checkbox"/> Reference made |
| The Waiter                | Rooftop party                          | 2 beats    | <input type="checkbox"/> Reference made |
| The Coworker              | Market crash                           | 2 beats    | <input type="checkbox"/> Reference made |

The Protagonist  
ADULT · AGES 25–30 · MAIN CHARACTER



☐ Reference made

**CHARACTER PROMPT**  
Character reference sheet of the protagonist: a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan. Show him four times side by side, full body front view, same face and hair in every pose, deadpan expression: (1) black hoodie with the hood up, (2) black crewneck sweater, (3) black quarter-zip pullover, (4) dark tailored jacket over a black tee. Plain light-gray background, outfit labels under each pose. Flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, semi-chibi proportions with an oversized head. He is always the darkest value in the frame.

**APPEARS IN BEATS (tap to jump)**  
1, 2, 4, 5, 6, 10, 13, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 110, 111, 112, 114, 115, 118, 119, 120, 122, 123, 124, 125, 126, 128, 129, 130, 134, 137, 138, 141 ... +67 more

## The Protagonist (younger)

AGE 22-24 · FLASHBACKS  
AND EARLY YEARS



☐ Reference made

### CHARACTER PROMPT

Character reference sheet, full body, front view and three-quarter view side by side, neutral standing pose, plain light-gray background, consistent proportions. The protagonist at age 22: a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, slightly thinner and more tired, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, worn jeans and old sneakers, holding a cardboard box. Flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, semi-chibi proportions with an oversized head.

### APPEARS IN BEATS (tap to jump)

28, 30, 33, 36, 38, 39, 42, 43, 44, 48, 49, 51, 52, 59, 63, 64, 65, 70, 71, 72, 75, 76, 77, 80, 81, 89, 90, 91, 92, 95, 96, 97, 100, 104, 105, 108

## Marcus

FRIEND · FLASHY RENTER  
DOWNTOWN

☐ Reference made

### CHARACTER PROMPT

Character reference sheet, full body, front view and three-quarter view side by side, neutral standing pose, plain light-gray background, consistent proportions. Marcus: a tall, stylish man in his late twenties with a neat fade haircut and a confident grin, wearing a cream linen shirt, slim chinos, loafers and a luxury wristwatch, holding a cocktail. Flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, semi-chibi proportions with an oversized head.

### APPEARS IN BEATS (tap to jump)

2, 3, 6, 7, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 21, 22, 24, 25, 26, 50, 56, 60, 61, 63, 81, 87, 88, 121, 126, 142, 143, 153, 161, 162, 174, 186, 187, 188, 191, 193, 223, 224, 225, 226, 227 ... +1 more

## Theo

FRIEND · HOMEOWNER  
WITH THE RED DOOR

☐ Reference made

### CHARACTER PROMPT

Character reference sheet, full body, front view and three-quarter view side by side, neutral standing pose, plain light-gray background, consistent proportions. Theo: a stocky bearded man in his late twenties with tired eyes and a friendly half-smile, wearing a flannel shirt, jeans and work boots. Flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, semi-chibi proportions with an oversized head.

### APPEARS IN BEATS (tap to jump)

6, 8, 9, 12, 21, 22, 24, 25, 26, 50, 60, 61, 62, 63, 81, 82, 88, 126, 142, 143, 153, 174, 175, 177, 178, 179, 180, 181, 183, 184, 185, 193, 234, 251

## Jenna

FRIEND · THEO'S WIFE

☐ Reference made

### CHARACTER PROMPT

Character reference sheet, full body, front view and three-quarter view side by side, neutral standing pose, plain light-gray background, consistent proportions. Jenna: a warm woman in her late twenties with a long auburn ponytail and a kind smile, wearing a mustard cardigan over a white tee and jeans, house keys on a red ribbon in her hand. Flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, semi-chibi proportions with an oversized head.

### APPEARS IN BEATS (tap to jump)

6, 8, 9, 12, 18, 19, 21, 22, 24, 25, 26, 50, 60, 61, 63, 81, 82, 85, 88, 126, 142, 143, 153, 174, 175, 177, 178, 179, 193, 234, 251

## Priya

FRIEND · THE ONE WHO  
NOTICES

☐ Reference made

### CHARACTER PROMPT

Character reference sheet, full body, front view and three-quarter view side by side, neutral standing pose, plain light-gray background, consistent proportions. Priya: a calm, observant woman in her late twenties with dark wavy shoulder-length hair and small gold hoop earrings, wearing an olive jacket, black top and jeans, a thoughtful neutral expression. Flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, semi-chibi proportions with an oversized head.

### APPEARS IN BEATS (tap to jump)

6, 10, 21, 22, 24, 25, 26, 50, 60, 61, 63, 81, 88, 124, 125, 126, 127, 128, 129, 130, 142, 143, 174, 193, 234, 237, 252, 254, 259, 260, 262, 264, 265, 266, 267

**Mother**

HIS MOTHER

☐ Reference made**CHARACTER PROMPT**

Character reference sheet, full body, front view and three-quarter view side by side, neutral standing pose, plain light-gray background, consistent proportions. His mother: a small woman in her late fifties with short graying hair and reading glasses on a beaded chain, wearing a faded maroon cardigan over a floral blouse, a gentle protective expression. Flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, semi-chibi proportions with an oversized head.

**APPEARS IN BEATS (tap to jump)**

34, 38, 44, 45, 46, 97, 137, 138, 140, 145, 209, 210, 211, 212, 213, 214, 217, 218, 219, 248, 262, 263, 273, 278, 279, 280

**Father**

HIS FATHER

☐ Reference made**CHARACTER PROMPT**

Character reference sheet, full body, front view and three-quarter view side by side, neutral standing pose, plain light-gray background, consistent proportions. His father: a heavysset man in his sixties with a gray mustache and a gruff but kind face, wearing a worn plaid shirt, khakis and reading glasses in his pocket. Flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, semi-chibi proportions with an oversized head.

**APPEARS IN BEATS (tap to jump)**

44, 51, 52, 53, 54, 55, 97, 132, 145, 146, 198, 200, 201, 204, 205, 248, 262, 273, 281, 282, 283, 284

**Alana**

THE DATE

☐ Reference made**CHARACTER PROMPT**

Character reference sheet, full body, front view and three-quarter view side by side, neutral standing pose, plain light-gray background, consistent proportions. Alana: a lively woman in her mid-twenties with curly black hair and an expressive smile, wearing a rust-colored sweater and gold earrings. Flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, semi-chibi proportions with an oversized head.

**APPEARS IN BEATS (tap to jump)**

90, 91, 92, 93, 95, 96

**Greg**

HIS MANAGER

☐ Reference made**CHARACTER PROMPT**

Character reference sheet, full body, front view and three-quarter view side by side, neutral standing pose, plain light-gray background, consistent proportions. Greg: a friendly balding middle-aged manager with a round face, wearing a tucked-in navy polo, khakis and a lanyard badge. Flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, semi-chibi proportions with an oversized head.

**APPEARS IN BEATS (tap to jump)**

103, 104, 105, 106, 107, 108

**Aunt Denise**

THANKSGIVING RELATIVE

☐ Reference made**CHARACTER PROMPT**

Character reference sheet, full body, front view and three-quarter view side by side, neutral standing pose, plain light-gray background, consistent proportions. Aunt Denise: a heavysset woman in her sixties with teased hair and a sugary, nosy smile, wearing a bold red blouse and pearl necklace. Flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, semi-chibi proportions with an oversized head.

**APPEARS IN BEATS (tap to jump)**

65, 66

**Cousin Kyle**

THANKSGIVING RELATIVE

☐ Reference made**CHARACTER PROMPT**

Character reference sheet, full body, front view and three-quarter view side by side, neutral standing pose, plain light-gray background, consistent proportions. Cousin Kyle: a broad young man around twenty-four in a trucker cap and a team jersey, cocky grin, holding a car key fob. Flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, semi-chibi proportions with an oversized head.

**APPEARS IN BEATS (tap to jump)**

67, 68, 69, 72, 176

**The Uncle**

THANKSGIVING RELATIVE

☐ Reference made**CHARACTER PROMPT**

Character reference sheet, full body, front view and three-quarter view side by side, neutral standing pose, plain light-gray background, consistent proportions. His uncle: a loud gray-haired man in his sixties wearing a sweater vest over a collared shirt, a booming laugh. Flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, semi-chibi proportions with an oversized head.

**APPEARS IN BEATS (tap to jump)**  
70

**The Leasing Agent**

DOWNTOWN LOFT

☐ Reference made**CHARACTER PROMPT**

Character reference sheet, full body, front view and three-quarter view side by side, neutral standing pose, plain light-gray background, consistent proportions. The leasing agent: a polished young woman in a fitted gray blazer with a sleek bun, holding a tablet and a silver pen, a practiced sales smile. Flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, semi-chibi proportions with an oversized head.

**APPEARS IN BEATS (tap to jump)**  
115, 116, 117, 119, 120

**The Mechanic**

REPAIR SHOP

☐ Reference made**CHARACTER PROMPT**

Character reference sheet, full body, front view and three-quarter view side by side, neutral standing pose, plain light-gray background, consistent proportions. The mechanic: an older man in blue coveralls with grease-stained knuckles, a short gray beard and a shop rag in his back pocket. Flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, semi-chibi proportions with an oversized head.

**APPEARS IN BEATS (tap to jump)**  
166, 167

**The Loan Officer**

THE HOUSE PURCHASE

☐ Reference made**CHARACTER PROMPT**

Character reference sheet, full body, front view and three-quarter view side by side, neutral standing pose, plain light-gray background, consistent proportions. The loan officer: a middle-aged man in a navy suit and striped tie, neatly combed hair, holding a thick file folder. Flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, semi-chibi proportions with an oversized head.

**APPEARS IN BEATS (tap to jump)**  
271, 272, 274, 275

**The Waiter**

ROOFTOP PARTY

☐ Reference made**CHARACTER PROMPT**

Character reference sheet, full body, front view and three-quarter view side by side, neutral standing pose, plain light-gray background, consistent proportions. The waiter: a young man in a black apron and white shirt holding a payment tablet. Flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, semi-chibi proportions with an oversized head.

**APPEARS IN BEATS (tap to jump)**  
14, 242

**The Coworker**

MARKET CRASH

☐ Reference made**CHARACTER PROMPT**

Character reference sheet, full body, front view and three-quarter view side by side, neutral standing pose, plain light-gray background, consistent proportions. The coworker: a nervous young man in a wrinkled dress shirt with a loosened tie and messy hair. Flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, semi-chibi proportions with an oversized head.

**APPEARS IN BEATS (tap to jump)**  
102, 149

STEP 2 OF 2

# Generate the beats

Tap a stage to jump straight to it.

288 beats · ~5s each  
00:00 – 24:06

| STAGE | TITLE                                                                             | BEATS               | TIME        |                                     |
|-------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|-------------|-------------------------------------|
| 1     | <b>The Rooftop</b><br>Age 30 · The secret in his pocket                           | 1-27<br>27 beats    | 00:00-02:17 | <input type="checkbox"/> Stage done |
| 2     | <b>The Driveway and the Rule</b><br>Age 22 · Four boxes and one decision          | 28-55<br>28 beats   | 02:17-04:43 | <input type="checkbox"/> Stage done |
| 3     | <b>"So When Are You Moving Out?"</b><br>Age 22-23 · The question that never stops | 56-79<br>24 beats   | 04:43-06:47 | <input type="checkbox"/> Stage done |
| 4     | <b>The Invisible Years</b><br>Age 23-24 · Everyone else's life, in pictures       | 80-109<br>30 beats  | 06:47-09:16 | <input type="checkbox"/> Stage done |
| 5     | <b>The Loft and the Mortgage</b><br>Age 25 · The pen, the envelope, the \$800     | 110-143<br>34 beats | 09:16-12:07 | <input type="checkbox"/> Stage done |
| 6     | <b>The Crash</b><br>Age 26 · When fear doesn't get a vote                         | 144-173<br>30 beats | 12:07-14:34 | <input type="checkbox"/> Stage done |
| 7     | <b>The Reversal</b><br>Age 27 · Lives that have to be fed                         | 174-194<br>21 beats | 14:34-16:14 | <input type="checkbox"/> Stage done |
| 8     | <b>The Nine Seconds</b><br>Age 28 · What the rent money really bought             | 195-214<br>20 beats | 16:14-17:58 | <input type="checkbox"/> Stage done |
| 9     | <b>The Cost of Silence</b><br>Age 29 · When the secret becomes a wall             | 215-240<br>26 beats | 17:58-20:11 | <input type="checkbox"/> Stage done |
| 10    | <b>Back on the Rooftop</b><br>Age 30 · Paid in full                               | 241-268<br>28 beats | 20:11-22:24 | <input type="checkbox"/> Stage done |
| 11    | <b>Moving Out</b><br>After · The last star                                        | 269-288<br>20 beats | 22:24-24:06 | <input type="checkbox"/> Stage done |

STAGE 1 OF 11

The Rooftop

Age 30 · The secret in his pocket

Beats 1–27 · 27 images  
00:00 – 02:17

STAGE NOTES

|                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>001</div> <div>BEAT</div> <div>00:00</div> <div>4.8s</div> <div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Image</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Animated</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Placed</div></div> | <div><p>“It’s 7:40 on a Saturday night and you’re standing on a rooftop downtown,”</p></div> <div><div>CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT</div><div>The Protagonist</div></div> <div><div>IMAGE PROMPT</div><div>Wide view of a downtown rooftop party at night, the protagonist standing near the railing holding a cocktail glass, guests mingling, string lights overhead, a glowing heated pool behind. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide establishing shot, protagonist off-center left. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: stylish, quietly detached.</div></div> <div><div><div>CAMERA</div><div>wide establishing shot, protagonist off-center left</div></div><div><div>LIGHTING</div><div>warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline</div></div><div><div>MOOD</div><div>stylish, quietly detached</div></div><div><div>ACTION</div><div>holding his drink, observing the party</div></div></div>                                 |
| <div>002</div> <div>BEAT</div> <div>00:04</div> <div>5.6s</div> <div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Image</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Animated</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Placed</div></div> | <div><p>“holding a drink you didn’t pay for. It’s Marcus’s thirtieth birthday. His building. His roof.”</p></div> <div><div>CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT</div><div>The ProtagonistMarcus</div></div> <div><div>IMAGE PROMPT</div><div>The protagonist holding a fancy cocktail he didn’t buy, a “Happy 30th Marcus” gold balloon banner strung behind him, Marcus laughing with guests in the background. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Marcus is a tall, stylish man in his late twenties with a neat fade haircut, a confident grin and a cream linen shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: celebratory, ironic.</div></div> <div><div><div>CAMERA</div><div>medium shot</div></div><div><div>LIGHTING</div><div>warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline</div></div><div><div>MOOD</div><div>celebratory, ironic</div></div><div><div>ACTION</div><div>glancing at the banner</div></div></div> |

## 003

BEAT

00:10

5.2s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*“His heated pool glowing blue behind everyone's heads. Your phone buzzes in your pocket.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT **Marcus**

## IMAGE PROMPT

A sleek luxury apartment rooftop with a heated pool glowing turquoise, Marcus posing proudly beside it, guests' heads silhouetted against the blue glow. Character notes: Marcus is a tall, stylish man in his late twenties with a neat fade haircut, a confident grin and a cream linen shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: low-angle wide shot. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: showy, affluent.

## CAMERA

low-angle wide shot

## LIGHTING

warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline

## MOOD

showy, affluent

## ACTION

Marcus spreading his arms proudly

## 004

BEAT

00:15

4.8s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*“You don't need to look. You already know what it says. One line.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT **The Protagonist**

## IMAGE PROMPT

The protagonist's calm face in profile, eyes half-lidded, a faint glowing outline of a phone notification reflected in his glasses. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: tight close-up. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: knowing, private.

## CAMERA

tight close-up

## LIGHTING

warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline

## MOOD

knowing, private

## ACTION

not reaching for the phone

## 005

BEAT

00:20

5.6s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*“A balance. Two words after it. Paid in full. You keep it in your pocket.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT **The Protagonist**

## IMAGE PROMPT

A ghostly overlay of a phone notification floating beside the protagonist reading "Paid in full", blurred so the details stay hidden. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up with overlay. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: mysterious.

## CAMERA

close-up with overlay

## LIGHTING

warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline

## MOOD

mysterious

## ACTION

the notification hovering faintly

## 006

BEAT

00:25

4.8s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*“There are five of you up here. The same five since sophomore year.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist Marcus Theo Jenna Priya

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Five friends standing together at the rooftop railing: the protagonist, Marcus, Theo, Jenna and Priya, the city skyline behind them. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Marcus is a tall, stylish man in his late twenties with a neat fade haircut, a confident grin and a cream linen shirt; Theo is a stocky bearded man with tired eyes in a flannel shirt; Jenna is a warm woman with a long auburn ponytail and a mustard cardigan; Priya is a calm, observant woman with dark wavy shoulder-length hair, small gold hoop earrings and an olive jacket. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium-wide group shot. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: familiar, nostalgic.

**CAMERA**

medium-wide group shot

**LIGHTING**

warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline

**MOOD**

familiar, nostalgic

**ACTION**

the friends clinking glasses

## 007

BEAT

00:30

4.8s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*“Marcus in a linen shirt with the tags still on the inside collar.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** Marcus

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Marcus in a crisp linen shirt with a visible price tag still peeking out of the inside collar, holding a cocktail and grinning. Character notes: Marcus is a tall, stylish man in his late twenties with a neat fade haircut, a confident grin and a cream linen shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium close-up on Marcus. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: flashy, careless.

**CAMERA**

medium close-up on Marcus

**LIGHTING**

warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline

**MOOD**

flashy, careless

**ACTION**

adjusting his collar without noticing the tag

## 008

BEAT

00:35

4.1s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*“Theo and Jenna holding hands, a little tired, a little proud,”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** Theo Jenna

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Theo and Jenna holding hands at the party, both looking tired but proud, house keys on a ribbon clipped to Jenna's bag. Character notes: Theo is a stocky bearded man with tired eyes in a flannel shirt; Jenna is a warm woman with a long auburn ponytail and a mustard cardigan. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: settled, weary pride.

**CAMERA**

medium two-shot

**LIGHTING**

warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline

**MOOD**

settled, weary pride

**ACTION**

leaning into each other

**009**

BEAT

**00:39**

4.1s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“the way people look when they own a house. And Priya,”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** Theo Jenna

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Theo and Jenna standing together like a classic homeowner couple, a tiny thought bubble above them showing a small house with a red door. Character notes: Theo is a stocky bearded man with tired eyes in a flannel shirt; Jenna is a warm woman with a long auburn ponytail and a mustard cardigan. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: proud, slightly strained.

**CAMERA**

medium two-shot

**LIGHTING**

warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline

**MOOD**

proud, slightly strained

**ACTION**

smiling politely

**010**

BEAT

**00:43**

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“who notices everything and says almost none of it. Marcus taps a spoon against his glass.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist Priya

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Priya standing a little apart from the group, watching everyone quietly with a drink, her eyes landing on the protagonist. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Priya is a calm, observant woman with dark wavy shoulder-length hair, small gold hoop earrings and an olive jacket. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot, protagonist soft in foreground. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: observant, quiet.

**CAMERA**

medium shot, protagonist soft in foreground

**LIGHTING**

warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline

**MOOD**

observant, quiet

**ACTION**

watching silently

**011**

BEAT

**00:49**

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“He gives a speech about thirty. About building something. About how everyone up here made it.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** Marcus

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Marcus giving a toast with one hand raised, speech-bubble icons of a house, a building and a trophy around him, guests cheering. Character notes: Marcus is a tall, stylish man in his late twenties with a neat fade haircut, a confident grin and a cream linen shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot from the crowd. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: triumphant, showy.

**CAMERA**

medium shot from the crowd

**LIGHTING**

warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline

**MOOD**

triumphant, showy

**ACTION**

gesturing grandly

## 012

BEAT

00:55

5.9s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*“He raises his drink toward Theo and Jenna's house, toward his own building, toward the city.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Marcus** **Theo** **Jenna**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Marcus raising his glass toward Theo and Jenna and then toward the luxury building behind him, the crowd's glasses lifting. Character notes: Marcus is a tall, stylish man in his late twenties with a neat fade haircut, a confident grin and a cream linen shirt; Theo is a stocky bearded man with tired eyes in a flannel shirt; Jenna is a warm woman with a long auburn ponytail and a mustard cardigan. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium-wide shot. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: celebratory, self-congratulatory.

**CAMERA**

medium-wide shot

**LIGHTING**

warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline

**MOOD**

celebratory, self-congratulatory

**ACTION**

sweeping his glass across the room

## 013

BEAT

01:01

4.8s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*“When his glass swings past you, it slows down for half a second.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist** **Marcus**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Marcus's glass sweeping past the protagonist and slowing for a beat, Marcus's smile flickering awkwardly, the protagonist deadpan. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Marcus is a tall, stylish man in his late twenties with a neat fade haircut, a confident grin and a cream linen shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: awkward, subtle exclusion.

**CAMERA**

medium two-shot

**LIGHTING**

warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline

**MOOD**

awkward, subtle exclusion

**ACTION**

the glass pausing near him

## 014

BEAT

01:06

5.6s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*“Then it keeps going. The waiter comes by with a tablet. Marcus waves him off.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Marcus** **The Waiter**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A young waiter in a black apron offering a payment tablet, Marcus waving him away with a flick of his hand. Character notes: Marcus is a tall, stylish man in his late twenties with a neat fade haircut, a confident grin and a cream linen shirt; the waiter is a young man in a black apron. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: generous, showy.

**CAMERA**

medium shot

**LIGHTING**

warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline

**MOOD**

generous, showy

**ACTION**

Marcus waving off the bill

## 015

BEAT

01:11

5.6s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Tonight's on me, he says. Then he turns to you, grinning, warm, a little loud.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist** **Marcus**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Marcus turning toward the protagonist with a big, warm, loud grin, one arm around his shoulder. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Marcus is a tall, stylish man in his late twenties with a neat fade haircut, a confident grin and a cream linen shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: teasing, friendly.

**CAMERA**

medium two-shot

**LIGHTING**

warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline

**MOOD**

teasing, friendly

**ACTION**

throwing an arm around him

## 016

BEAT

01:17

6.3s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“And you're still at your mom's, right? Still in the room with the stars on the ceiling?”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A thought bubble above the group showing a childhood bedroom ceiling covered in glowing plastic stars, the protagonist below it. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot with thought bubble. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: embarrassing, nostalgic.

**CAMERA**

medium shot with thought bubble

**LIGHTING**

warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline

**MOOD**

embarrassing, nostalgic

**ACTION**

everyone imagining the bedroom

## 017

BEAT

01:23

4.8s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Everybody laughs. Not mean. Just familiar. You laugh too. Jenna touches your arm.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The friend group bursting into laughter, the protagonist laughing along with a flat, half-hearted smile. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium-wide group shot. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: light teasing, hidden sting.

**CAMERA**

medium-wide group shot

**LIGHTING**

warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline

**MOOD**

light teasing, hidden sting

**ACTION**

everyone laughing

## 018

BEAT

01:28

5.2s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*“If you ever need a place, she says, we have the spare room now.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist Jenna

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Jenna touching the protagonist's arm kindly with a sympathetic expression. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Jenna is a warm woman with a long auburn ponytail and a mustard cardigan. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: kind, pitying.

**CAMERA**

medium two-shot

**LIGHTING**

warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline

**MOOD**

kind, pitying

**ACTION**

Jenna resting her hand on his arm

## 019

BEAT

01:33

4.1s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*“Seriously. No rush. You say thanks. You mean it. You're thirty.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist Jenna

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist nodding to Jenna with a small sincere look, his drink held low. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Jenna is a warm woman with a long auburn ponytail and a mustard cardigan. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up on the protagonist. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: grateful, quiet.

**CAMERA**

close-up on the protagonist

**LIGHTING**

warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline

**MOOD**

grateful, quiet

**ACTION**

nodding thanks

## 020

BEAT

01:37

5.9s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*“You still sleep in the bedroom you slept in at nine. And sitting on that rooftop,”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Split frame: the protagonist on the rooftop at thirty, and a small inset of the same bedroom with a twin bed and a nine-year-old version of him sleeping. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: split-screen medium shot. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: ironic, intimate.

**CAMERA**

split-screen medium shot

**LIGHTING**

warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline

**MOOD**

ironic, intimate

**ACTION**

standing still at the railing

021

BEAT

01:43

5.2s

☐ Image

☐ Animated

☐ Placed

“you have more money than anyone holding a glass. Not more income. More money.”

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEATThe ProtagonistMarcusTheoJennaPriya

IMAGE PROMPT  
The protagonist at the railing with faint gold numbers floating behind him like a ghostly bank balance, friends' glasses glinting beside him. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: the friends are Marcus (tall, fade haircut, linen shirt), Theo (stocky, bearded, flannel), Jenna (auburn ponytail, mustard cardigan) and Priya (dark wavy hair, olive jacket). Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: secret wealth, quiet power.

| CAMERA      | LIGHTING                                                                                       | MOOD                       | ACTION             |
|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|--------------------|
| medium shot | warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline | secret wealth, quiet power | gazing at the city |

022

BEAT

01:48

5.2s

☐ Image

☐ Animated

☐ Placed

“The kind that stays. None of them know. Not Marcus. Not Theo. Not Jenna.”

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEATThe ProtagonistMarcusTheoJennaPriya

IMAGE PROMPT  
The four friends laughing in a row, each with a small question-mark icon over their heads, the protagonist watching them. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: the friends are Marcus (tall, fade haircut, linen shirt), Theo (stocky, bearded, flannel), Jenna (auburn ponytail, mustard cardigan) and Priya (dark wavy hair, olive jacket). Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium-wide shot. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: secret, ironic.

| CAMERA           | LIGHTING                                                                                       | MOOD           | ACTION                   |
|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|--------------------------|
| medium-wide shot | warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline | secret, ironic | friends laughing unaware |

023

BEAT

01:54

5.2s

☐ Image

☐ Animated

☐ Placed

“Not even Priya. Here's what nobody tells you about the years everyone pities you.”

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEATThe Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT  
The protagonist alone in a spotlight on a dark stage, a faint crowd of pitying faces around the edges. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide stylized shot. Lighting: dramatic single spotlight in darkness. Mood: introspective, revealing.

| CAMERA             | LIGHTING                              | MOOD                     | ACTION                          |
|--------------------|---------------------------------------|--------------------------|---------------------------------|
| wide stylized shot | dramatic single spotlight in darkness | introspective, revealing | standing still in the spotlight |

## 024

BEAT

01:59

6.3s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“They don’t feel like a plan. They feel like an apology you keep making at every dinner.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist Marcus Theo Jenna Priya

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A montage of dinner tables with the protagonist apologizing with a raised hand at each one, friends' faces skeptical. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: the friends are Marcus (tall, fade haircut, linen shirt), Theo (stocky, bearded, flannel), Jenna (auburn ponytail, mustard cardigan) and Priya (dark wavy hair, olive jacket). Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: three-panel montage. Lighting: warm dining light. Mood: weary, repetitive.

**CAMERA**

three-panel montage

**LIGHTING**

warm dining light

**MOOD**

weary, repetitive

**ACTION**

raising his hand apologetically

## 025

BEAT

02:05

4.1s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“This is how the friend everyone assumed was stuck turned out”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist Marcus Theo Jenna Priya

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist sitting slumped on a tiny stool labeled "STUCK" while the friends stand on taller pedestals. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: the friends are Marcus (tall, fade haircut, linen shirt), Theo (stocky, bearded, flannel), Jenna (auburn ponytail, mustard cardigan) and Priya (dark wavy hair, olive jacket). Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium-wide stylized shot. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: misjudged.

**CAMERA**

medium-wide stylized shot

**LIGHTING**

warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline

**MOOD**

misjudged

**ACTION**

sitting calmly on the stool

## 026

BEAT

02:09

4.1s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“to be the only one not paying for someone else's house.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist Marcus Theo Jenna Priya

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A row of houses with tiny strings attached to the friends' hands like puppets, and the protagonist standing free with no strings. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: the friends are Marcus (tall, fade haircut, linen shirt), Theo (stocky, bearded, flannel), Jenna (auburn ponytail, mustard cardigan) and Priya (dark wavy hair, olive jacket). Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide metaphorical shot. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: revealing, ironic.

**CAMERA**

wide metaphorical shot

**LIGHTING**

warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline

**MOOD**

revealing, ironic

**ACTION**

the protagonist standing apart

027

BEAT

02:13

3.3s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

“And why saying it out loud kept getting harder.”

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT **The Protagonist**

IMAGE PROMPT

The protagonist's mouth zipped with a small cartoon zipper, the party blurred behind him. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: secretive, heavy.

| CAMERA   | LIGHTING                                                                                       | MOOD             | ACTION         |
|----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|----------------|
| close-up | warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline | secretive, heavy | staying silent |

## STAGE 2 OF 11

# The Driveway and the Rule

Age 22 · Four boxes and one decision

Beats 28–55 · 28 images

02:17 – 04:43

## STAGE NOTES

**028**

BEAT

**02:17**

3.7s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Eight years earlier, you're twenty-two, standing in your parents' driveway”***CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist (younger)**IMAGE PROMPT**

A desaturated flashback of a suburban driveway, the younger protagonist standing beside an old sedan at age twenty-two. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide shot, desaturated. Lighting: flat cool overcast light, desaturated. Mood: tired beginnings.

**CAMERA**

wide shot, desaturated

**LIGHTING**

flat cool overcast light, desaturated

**MOOD**

tired beginnings

**ACTION**

standing in the driveway

**029**

BEAT

**02:20**

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“with everything you own in four cardboard boxes and a laundry basket.”***CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)**IMAGE PROMPT**

Four cardboard boxes and a plastic laundry basket stacked on the driveway, labeled in marker "BOOKS", "CLOTHES", "KITCHEN", "MISC". Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: flat cool overcast light. Mood: sparse, humble.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

flat cool overcast light

**MOOD**

sparse, humble

**ACTION**

boxes sitting on the concrete

**030**

BEAT

**02:25**

3.7s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“You have a degree. A job offer. \$41,000 a year.”***CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist (younger)**IMAGE PROMPT**

The younger protagonist holding a diploma and an offer letter reading "Salary: \$41,000", the house behind him. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: flat cool overcast light. Mood: modest achievement.

**CAMERA**

medium shot

**LIGHTING**

flat cool overcast light

**MOOD**

modest achievement

**ACTION**

holding up the papers

## 031

BEAT

02:28

4.8s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*“You also have \$19,000 in student loans and \$2,500 in a checking account.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Close-up of a laptop showing "Student Loans: \$19,000" and "Checking: \$2,500" on a cluttered desk. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones. Mood: heavy, sobering.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones

**MOOD**

heavy, sobering

**ACTION**

the numbers glowing on screen

## 032

BEAT

02:33

5.2s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*“Your net worth sits around negative sixteen thousand. You tell everyone the same thing.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A simple bar chart on a phone screen dipping below zero with the label "Net worth: -\$16,500". Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones. Mood: bleak.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones

**MOOD**

bleak

**ACTION**

the bar sitting below the line

## 033

BEAT

02:38

3.7s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*“Just for a few months. Just until I get settled.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist (younger)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The younger protagonist on the phone in the driveway, holding up one finger, a speech bubble reading "Just a few months". The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: flat cool overcast light. Mood: reassuring, unconvincing.

**CAMERA**

medium shot

**LIGHTING**

flat cool overcast light

**MOOD**

reassuring, unconvincing

**ACTION**

talking on the phone

## 034

BEAT

02:42

4.4s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*“Your mother has cleared out the closet. She's washed the old comforter.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** Mother

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A modest childhood bedroom with an emptied closet and a freshly washed blue comforter folded on a twin bed, his mother smoothing it. Character notes: his mother is a small woman in her late fifties with short graying hair, reading glasses on a beaded chain and a faded maroon cardigan. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide shot of the bedroom. Lighting: flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones. Mood: caring, nostalgic.

**CAMERA**

wide shot of the bedroom

**LIGHTING**

flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones

**MOOD**

caring, nostalgic

**ACTION**

his mother smoothing the comforter

## 035

BEAT

02:47

5.6s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*“She hasn't touched the ceiling. Thirty-one glow-in-the-dark stars, stuck up there when you were nine.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Close-up of thirty-one yellowed glow-in-the-dark plastic stars stuck to a white ceiling in a childish pattern. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones. Mood: nostalgic, small.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones

**MOOD**

nostalgic, small

**ACTION**

the stars on the ceiling

## 036

BEAT

02:52

4.1s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*“They still light up faintly when you turn the lamp off.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist (younger)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The bedroom in darkness, the plastic stars glowing faintly green above the younger protagonist lying on the twin bed. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide shot. Lighting: dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars. Mood: quiet, nostalgic.

**CAMERA**

wide shot

**LIGHTING**

dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars

**MOOD**

quiet, nostalgic

**ACTION**

the lamp clicking off

## 037

BEAT

02:56

6.3s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*“The spare key is on the hook by the door. Same faded blue lanyard from high school.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A hallway by the front door with a wall hook holding a single brass key on a faded blue lanyard. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones. Mood: homey, symbolic.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones

**MOOD**

homey, symbolic

**ACTION**

the key hanging on the hook

## 038

BEAT

03:02

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Your mother hands it to you like it's a formality. Like you never gave it back.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist (younger) Mother

**IMAGE PROMPT**

His mother handing the younger protagonist the key on the blue lanyard in the hallway, smiling softly. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: his mother is a small woman in her late fifties with short graying hair, reading glasses on a beaded chain and a faded maroon cardigan. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones. Mood: warm, matter-of-fact.

**CAMERA**

medium two-shot

**LIGHTING**

flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones

**MOOD**

warm, matter-of-fact

**ACTION**

placing the key in his hand

## 039

BEAT

03:08

4.8s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“The first night, you lie under the stars and open a rental app.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist (younger)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The younger protagonist lying in bed under the glowing stars, his face lit by a phone showing a rental listing app. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot from above. Lighting: dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars. Mood: curious, wistful.

**CAMERA**

medium shot from above

**LIGHTING**

dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars

**MOOD**

curious, wistful

**ACTION**

scrolling the app

## 040

BEAT

03:13

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“A one-bedroom across town. \$1,450 a month. Plus utilities. Plus parking. Call it \$1,700.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Phone screen showing an apartment listing "1BR Across Town \$1,450/mo" with small icons for utilities and parking. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars. Mood: tempting.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars

**MOOD**

tempting

**ACTION**

the listing on screen

## 041

BEAT

03:18

6.3s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*“That's what being a grown-up costs in this city. That's the number everyone your age is paying.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Phone calculator showing "\$1,700" with a small grown-up figure in a suit icon beside it. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars. Mood: sobering.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars

**MOOD**

sobering

**ACTION**

the total glowing

## 042

BEAT

03:25

5.9s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*“And then you make a decision so small it feels like nothing. You'll pay it anyway.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist (younger)**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The younger protagonist lying still under the stars, a tiny lightbulb icon appearing faintly over his head. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium close-up. Lighting: dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars. Mood: quiet decision.

**CAMERA**

medium close-up

**LIGHTING**

dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars

**MOOD**

quiet decision

**ACTION**

his eyes narrowing in thought

## 043

BEAT

03:31

5.9s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*“Every month, \$1,700 leaves your paycheck, just like it would if you had your own place.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist (younger)**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A split image: the younger protagonist paying into a jar labeled "RENT" in his childhood bedroom, and a stranger paying a landlord. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: the landlord is a smug middle-aged man in an expensive suit. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: split-screen medium shot. Lighting: flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones. Mood: parallel, deliberate.

**CAMERA**

split-screen medium shot

**LIGHTING**

flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones

**MOOD**

parallel, deliberate

**ACTION**

dropping money into the jar

## 044

BEAT

03:37

3.7s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“\$500 goes to your parents. They try to refuse it.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist (younger) Mother Father

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The younger protagonist placing an envelope marked "\$500" on the kitchen table, his parents shaking their heads with hands raised. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: his parents are a small graying woman in a faded maroon cardigan and a heavyset gray-mustached man in a plaid shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium three-shot in a modest kitchen. Lighting: warm overhead kitchen light. Mood: warm, stubborn.

| CAMERA                                | LIGHTING                    | MOOD           | ACTION               |
|---------------------------------------|-----------------------------|----------------|----------------------|
| medium three-shot in a modest kitchen | warm overhead kitchen light | warm, stubborn | his parents refusing |

## 045

BEAT

03:40

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Your mother pushes the first envelope back across the kitchen table. You push it back harder.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** Mother

**IMAGE PROMPT**

His mother pushing the envelope back across a worn kitchen table with two fingers. Character notes: his mother is a small woman in her late fifties with short graying hair, reading glasses on a beaded chain and a faded maroon cardigan. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up on the table. Lighting: warm overhead kitchen light. Mood: loving resistance.

| CAMERA                | LIGHTING                    | MOOD              | ACTION                    |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------|-------------------|---------------------------|
| close-up on the table | warm overhead kitchen light | loving resistance | sliding the envelope back |

## 046

BEAT

03:46

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“She takes it the way people take something they plan to argue about later.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** Mother

**IMAGE PROMPT**

His mother slowly picking up the envelope with a skeptical, pursed-lip expression. Character notes: his mother is a small woman in her late fifties with short graying hair, reading glasses on a beaded chain and a faded maroon cardigan. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up on his mother. Lighting: warm overhead kitchen light. Mood: reluctant, unfinished.

| CAMERA                 | LIGHTING                    | MOOD                  | ACTION               |
|------------------------|-----------------------------|-----------------------|----------------------|
| close-up on his mother | warm overhead kitchen light | reluctant, unfinished | lifting the envelope |

## 047

BEAT

03:51

5.9s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*“The other \$1,200 disappears the morning the paycheck lands. Automatic. Gone before you can miss it.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Phone notification at dawn reading "Auto-transfer: \$1,200 → Investment Account" on a nightstand beside a buzzing alarm clock. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: cool early-morning light. Mood: automatic, quiet.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

cool early-morning light

**MOOD**

automatic, quiet

**ACTION**

the notification lighting up

## 048

BEAT

03:57

5.6s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*“One rule. Made once. So you'd never have to decide again. You tell no one.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist (younger)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A single sticky note on the bedroom mirror reading "One rule.", the younger protagonist's reflection behind it. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium close-up through the mirror. Lighting: flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones. Mood: simple, firm.

**CAMERA**medium close-up  
through the mirror**LIGHTING**flat cool lamp light, washed-out  
blue-gray tones**MOOD**

simple, firm

**ACTION**

looking at the note

## 049

BEAT

04:03

6.3s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*“There's no way to say it that doesn't sound like an excuse. I live with my parents,”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist (younger)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The younger protagonist with an empty speech bubble struggling to fill it, crossed-out words scribbled inside. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium close-up. Lighting: flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones. Mood: awkward, unexplainable.

**CAMERA**

medium close-up

**LIGHTING**flat cool lamp light, washed-out  
blue-gray tones**MOOD**awkward,  
unexplainable**ACTION**

trying to find words

## 050

BEAT

04:09

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“but it's on purpose isn't a sentence anyone believes at twenty-two. The next morning,”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Marcus** **Theo** **Jenna** **Priya**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Close-up of a speech bubble reading "...on purpose" with friends' skeptical eye-rolls around it. Character notes: the friends are Marcus (tall, fade haircut, linen shirt), Theo (stocky, bearded, flannel), Jenna (auburn ponytail, mustard cardigan) and Priya (dark wavy hair, olive jacket). Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones. Mood: dismissive.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones

**MOOD**

dismissive

**ACTION**

the bubble shrinking

## 051

BEAT

04:14

6.3s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“your father is at the kitchen table with his coffee and the newspaper he still pays for.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist (younger)** **Father**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Morning kitchen, his father at the table with coffee, the younger protagonist in the background. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: his father is a heavyset man in his sixties with a gray mustache and a worn plaid shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium-wide shot of the kitchen. Lighting: soft cool morning light. Mood: ordinary, quiet.

**CAMERA**

medium-wide shot of the kitchen

**LIGHTING**

soft cool morning light

**MOOD**

ordinary, quiet

**ACTION**

his father sipping coffee

## 052

BEAT

04:21

5.6s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“He watches you pack a lunch in a reused takeout container. You sure about this?”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist (younger)** **Father**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The younger protagonist packing leftovers into a reused takeout container at the counter, his father watching over the newspaper. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: his father is a heavyset man in his sixties with a gray mustache and a worn plaid shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: soft cool morning light. Mood: frugal, observed.

**CAMERA**

medium two-shot

**LIGHTING**

soft cool morning light

**MOOD**

frugal, observed

**ACTION**

snapping the lid shut

**053**

BEAT

**04:26**

4.8s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“he asks. Not the living here. The other thing. He saw the envelope.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** Father**IMAGE PROMPT**

His father lowering the newspaper and asking a question with a raised eyebrow. Character notes: his father is a heavyset man in his sixties with a gray mustache and a worn plaid shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium close-up on his father. Lighting: soft cool morning light. Mood: curious, protective.

**CAMERA**

medium close-up on his father

**LIGHTING**

soft cool morning light

**MOOD**

curious, protective

**ACTION**

lowering the paper

**054**

BEAT

**04:31**

6.3s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“He doesn't know what the rest of the money is doing. He just knows you're doing something.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** Father**IMAGE PROMPT**

His father squinting thoughtfully, a thought bubble with a question mark and a dollar sign. Character notes: his father is a heavyset man in his sixties with a gray mustache and a worn plaid shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up on his father. Lighting: soft cool morning light. Mood: puzzled.

**CAMERA**

close-up on his father

**LIGHTING**

soft cool morning light

**MOOD**

puzzled

**ACTION**

thinking

**055**

BEAT

**04:37**

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“You say you're sure. You aren't. He nods and turns the page. He never asks again.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** Father**IMAGE PROMPT**

His father going back to his newspaper, turning the page calmly. Character notes: his father is a heavyset man in his sixties with a gray mustache and a worn plaid shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: soft cool morning light. Mood: trusting, quiet.

**CAMERA**

medium shot

**LIGHTING**

soft cool morning light

**MOOD**

trusting, quiet

**ACTION**

turning the page

## STAGE 3 OF 11

# "So When Are You Moving Out?"

Age 22–23 · The question that never stops

Beats 56–79 · 24 images

04:43 – 06:47

## STAGE NOTES

**056**

BEAT

**04:43**

4.8s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*"That first summer, Marcus throws a party at his new apartment. Exposed brick."***CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** Marcus**IMAGE PROMPT**

A lively apartment party with exposed brick walls, Marcus hosting with a drink in hand. Character notes: Marcus is a tall, stylish man in his late twenties with a neat fade haircut, a confident grin and a cream linen shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide shot. Lighting: warm party lighting. Mood: trendy, social.

**CAMERA**

wide shot

**LIGHTING**

warm party lighting

**MOOD**

trendy, social

**ACTION**

Marcus welcoming guests

**057**

BEAT

**04:48**

5.2s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*"A balcony. A dog-friendly building with no dog. Someone asks where everyone's living now,"***CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)**IMAGE PROMPT**

A small balcony with string lights, and a framed "Pet Friendly" sign beside an empty dog bed. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: warm party lighting. Mood: ironic, stylish.

**CAMERA**

medium shot

**LIGHTING**

warm party lighting

**MOOD**

ironic, stylish

**ACTION**

guests stepping onto the balcony

**058**

BEAT

**04:53**

4.4s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*"and the answers go around the circle like a toast. Downtown. Midtown."***CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)**IMAGE PROMPT**

Speech bubbles going around the circle reading "Downtown", "Midtown", each friend raising a glass. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium-wide shot. Lighting: warm party lighting. Mood: proud, competitive.

**CAMERA**

medium-wide shot

**LIGHTING**

warm party lighting

**MOOD**

proud, competitive

**ACTION**

glasses raising

**059**

BEAT

**04:58**

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*"That place by the river. Then they get to you. You say,"*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist (younger)**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A final bubble "By the river", then everyone turning to look at the younger protagonist. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: warm party lighting. Mood: expectant.

**CAMERA**

medium shot

**LIGHTING**

warm party lighting

**MOOD**

expectant

**ACTION**

heads turning

**060**

BEAT

**05:02**

5.6s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*"I'm at my parents' for a bit. And a small silence opens up. Not cruel."*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Marcus Theo Jenna Priya**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The circle of friends frozen mid-sip with polite, uncomfortable smiles. Character notes: the friends are Marcus (tall, fade haircut, linen shirt), Theo (stocky, bearded, flannel), Jenna (auburn ponytail, mustard cardigan) and Priya (dark wavy hair, olive jacket). Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium-wide shot. Lighting: warm party lighting. Mood: awkward, careful.

**CAMERA**

medium-wide shot

**LIGHTING**

warm party lighting

**MOOD**

awkward, careful

**ACTION**

everyone going still

**061**

BEAT

**05:08**

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*"Just careful. The kind of silence people make around something they don't want to step on."*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Marcus Theo Jenna Priya**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Friends tiptoeing carefully around the crack in the floor, avoiding eye contact. Character notes: the friends are Marcus (tall, fade haircut, linen shirt), Theo (stocky, bearded, flannel), Jenna (auburn ponytail, mustard cardigan) and Priya (dark wavy hair, olive jacket). Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium-wide shot. Lighting: warm party lighting. Mood: careful, avoidant.

**CAMERA**

medium-wide shot

**LIGHTING**

warm party lighting

**MOOD**

careful, avoidant

**ACTION**

tiptoeing

**062**

BEAT

**05:14**

5.6s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Then Theo asks the question. Not unkindly. Just curious. So when are you moving out?”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** Theo**IMAGE PROMPT**

Theo leaning forward on the couch with a curious, friendly expression. Character notes: Theo is a stocky bearded man with tired eyes in a flannel shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium close-up on Theo. Lighting: warm party lighting. Mood: innocent curiosity.

| CAMERA                  | LIGHTING            | MOOD               | ACTION              |
|-------------------------|---------------------|--------------------|---------------------|
| medium close-up on Theo | warm party lighting | innocent curiosity | asking the question |

**063**

BEAT

**05:19**

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“You say soon. Everyone nods. The conversation rolls on. You'll hear that question for eight years.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist (younger) Marcus Theo Jenna Priya**IMAGE PROMPT**

The younger protagonist answering, friends nodding and turning back to each other. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: the friends are Marcus (tall, fade haircut, linen shirt), Theo (stocky, bearded, flannel), Jenna (auburn ponytail, mustard cardigan) and Priya (dark wavy hair, olive jacket). Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium group shot. Lighting: warm party lighting. Mood: brushed off.

| CAMERA            | LIGHTING            | MOOD        | ACTION                     |
|-------------------|---------------------|-------------|----------------------------|
| medium group shot | warm party lighting | brushed off | the conversation moving on |

**064**

BEAT

**05:25**

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Thanksgiving that year, it gets asked by people who don't love you as gently.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist (younger)**IMAGE PROMPT**

Relatives at the table leaning toward the younger protagonist with nosy, judgmental expressions. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: the relatives are a mix of middle-aged and older family members in festive sweaters. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium-wide shot. Lighting: warm golden dining light. Mood: judgmental.

| CAMERA           | LIGHTING                 | MOOD       | ACTION               |
|------------------|--------------------------|------------|----------------------|
| medium-wide shot | warm golden dining light | judgmental | relatives leaning in |

**065**

BEAT

**05:30**

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*"Your aunt Denise sets down a dish of sweet potatoes and asks,"*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist (younger)** **Aunt Denise**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Aunt Denise setting down a dish of sweet potatoes and turning to the younger protagonist with a fake sweet smile. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Aunt Denise is a heavyset woman in her sixties with teased hair and a bold red blouse. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: warm golden dining light. Mood: nosy, sugary.

| CAMERA      | LIGHTING                 | MOOD         | ACTION                |
|-------------|--------------------------|--------------|-----------------------|
| medium shot | warm golden dining light | nosy, sugary | setting down the dish |

**066**

BEAT

**05:35**

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*"so where are you living now, honey? Before you can answer, your mother says,"*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Aunt Denise**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Close-up of Aunt Denise's raised eyebrows and a speech bubble with a small house icon and a question mark. Character notes: Aunt Denise is a heavyset woman in her sixties with teased hair and a bold red blouse. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up. Lighting: warm golden dining light. Mood: prying.

| CAMERA   | LIGHTING                 | MOOD   | ACTION |
|----------|--------------------------|--------|--------|
| close-up | warm golden dining light | prying | asking |

**067**

BEAT

**05:40**

5.6s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*"he's home with us, and something in the room adjusts. Your cousin Kyle is twenty-four."*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Cousin Kyle**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The relatives exchanging glances while Cousin Kyle sits up proudly across the table. Character notes: Cousin Kyle is a broad young man in a trucker cap and a team jersey; the relatives are a mix of middle-aged and older family members in festive sweaters. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium-wide shot. Lighting: warm golden dining light. Mood: shifting, judgmental.

| CAMERA           | LIGHTING                 | MOOD                 | ACTION         |
|------------------|--------------------------|----------------------|----------------|
| medium-wide shot | warm golden dining light | shifting, judgmental | glances traded |

**068**

BEAT

**05:45**

4.1s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*"He just bought a truck. \$640 a month for seventy-two months."*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Cousin Kyle**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Cousin Kyle holding up a phone photo of a shiny new pickup truck with a "\$640/mo x 72" overlay. Character notes: Cousin Kyle is a broad young man in a trucker cap and a team jersey. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: warm golden dining light. Mood: showy, financed.

| CAMERA          | LIGHTING                 | MOOD            | ACTION            |
|-----------------|--------------------------|-----------------|-------------------|
| close-up insert | warm golden dining light | showy, financed | showing the photo |

**069**

BEAT

**05:49**

5.6s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“He announces the payment like it's a trophy. Your uncle claps him on the back.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Cousin Kyle**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Cousin Kyle beaming and holding a car key fob up like a trophy, relatives clapping. Character notes: Cousin Kyle is a broad young man in a trucker cap and a team jersey; the relatives are a mix of middle-aged and older family members in festive sweaters. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: warm golden dining light. Mood: boastful.

| CAMERA      | LIGHTING                 | MOOD     | ACTION              |
|-------------|--------------------------|----------|---------------------|
| medium shot | warm golden dining light | boastful | raising the key fob |

**070**

BEAT

**05:55**

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Then he looks at you, and the hand doesn't come. He just says, well, no rush,”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist (younger)** **The Uncle**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

His uncle turning toward the younger protagonist, his hand hovering and then dropping to his side. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: his uncle is a loud gray-haired man in a sweater vest. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm golden dining light. Mood: withheld approval.

| CAMERA          | LIGHTING                 | MOOD              | ACTION              |
|-----------------|--------------------------|-------------------|---------------------|
| medium two-shot | warm golden dining light | withheld approval | the hand not coming |

**071**

BEAT

**06:01**

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“buddy. Everybody's on their own timeline. It's kind. It's also a verdict. You pass the rolls.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist (younger)**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The younger protagonist passing a basket of dinner rolls down the table, everyone else ignoring him. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: warm golden dining light. Mood: dismissed.

| CAMERA      | LIGHTING                 | MOOD      | ACTION            |
|-------------|--------------------------|-----------|-------------------|
| medium shot | warm golden dining light | dismissed | passing the rolls |

**072**

BEAT

**06:07**

5.6s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*"You notice nobody asks you a single follow-up question for the rest of the night."*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist (younger)** **Cousin Kyle**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The younger protagonist eating quietly at the end of the table while relatives chat animatedly with Kyle. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Cousin Kyle is a broad young man in a trucker cap and a team jersey; the relatives are a mix of middle-aged and older family members in festive sweaters. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium-wide shot. Lighting: warm golden dining light. Mood: ignored.

**CAMERA**

medium-wide shot

**LIGHTING**

warm golden dining light

**MOOD**

ignored

**ACTION**

eating silently

**073**

BEAT

**06:12**

4.1s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*"The first fourteen months, the \$1,200 doesn't build anything. It erases."*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **No characters (environment or insert shot)**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A bank app screen showing a "\$1,200" payment hitting a student loan, the loan bar shrinking. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones. Mood: focused, erasing.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones

**MOOD**

focused, erasing

**ACTION**

the bar shrinking

**074**

BEAT

**06:17**

4.8s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*"Loan statements shrink. \$19,000. Then \$13,000. Then \$6,400. You make the last payment"*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **No characters (environment or insert shot)**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Three loan statements side by side on a desk showing \$19,000, \$13,000 and \$6,400. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones. Mood: steady progress.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones

**MOOD**

steady progress

**ACTION**

statements laid out

**075**

BEAT

**06:21**

6.3s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“from your car in a grocery store parking lot on a Tuesday. The screen says balance zero.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist (younger)****IMAGE PROMPT**

Phone screen reading "Loan Balance: \$0.00" with the younger protagonist's still face reflected above it. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: flat cool overcast light. Mood: quiet triumph.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

flat cool overcast light

**MOOD**

quiet triumph

**ACTION**

the engine off

**076**

BEAT

**06:28**

4.8s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“You sit there with the engine off. Nobody to tell. You drive home”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist (younger)****IMAGE PROMPT**

Phone screen reading "Loan Balance: \$0.00" with the younger protagonist's still face reflected above it. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: flat cool overcast light. Mood: quiet triumph.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

flat cool overcast light

**MOOD**

quiet triumph

**ACTION**

the engine off

**077**

BEAT

**06:32**

5.6s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“and eat leftovers at the same kitchen table you ate cereal at in fourth grade.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist (younger)****IMAGE PROMPT**

The younger protagonist eating leftovers alone at a worn kitchen table at night. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium-wide shot. Lighting: warm overhead kitchen light. Mood: humble, ordinary.

**CAMERA**

medium-wide shot

**LIGHTING**

warm overhead kitchen light

**MOOD**

humble, ordinary

**ACTION**

eating quietly

**078**

BEAT

**06:38**

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“The next month, the \$1,200 finds a new home. An index fund.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Phone screen showing "Auto-transfer: \$1,200 → Index Fund" with a small seedling icon. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones. Mood: new beginning.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones

**MOOD**

new beginning

**ACTION**

the transfer going through

**079**

BEAT

**06:42**

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“The first deposit buys a few shares of something you'll never see.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Tiny share icons dropping into a dark, opaque box labeled "Index Fund". Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up metaphor. Lighting: flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones. Mood: invisible growth.

**CAMERA**

close-up metaphor

**LIGHTING**

flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones

**MOOD**

invisible growth

**ACTION**

shares dropping in

STAGE 4 OF 11

The Invisible Years

Age 23–24 · Everyone else's life, in pictures

Beats 80–109 · 30 images  
06:47 – 09:16

STAGE NOTES

|                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>080</div> <div>BEAT</div> <div>06:47</div> <div>4.4s</div> <div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Image</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Animated</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Placed</div></div> | <div><p>“Then come the years where it looks like you made a mistake.”</p></div> <div><div>CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT</div><div>The Protagonist (younger)</div></div> <div><div>IMAGE PROMPT</div><div>The younger protagonist standing still on a busy sidewalk while everyone else walks quickly past him in a blur. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide shot. Lighting: soft neutral daylight. Mood: stuck, doubtful.</div></div> <div><div><div>CAMERA</div><div>wide shot</div></div><div><div>LIGHTING</div><div>soft neutral daylight</div></div><div><div>MOOD</div><div>stuck, doubtful</div></div><div><div>ACTION</div><div>standing still</div></div></div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <div>081</div> <div>BEAT</div> <div>06:51</div> <div>3.7s</div> <div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Image</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Animated</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Placed</div></div> | <div><p>“Because everyone else's life starts happening on schedule. In public.”</p></div> <div><div>CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT</div><div>The Protagonist (younger)MarcusTheoJennaPriya</div></div> <div><div>IMAGE PROMPT</div><div>A group chat on a phone screen filling with photos of friends' new homes, cars and vacations, the younger protagonist's thumb scrolling. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: the friends are Marcus (tall, fade haircut, linen shirt), Theo (stocky, bearded, flannel), Jenna (auburn ponytail, mustard cardigan) and Priya (dark wavy hair, olive jacket). Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones. Mood: envious, public.</div></div> <div><div><div>CAMERA</div><div>close-up insert</div></div><div><div>LIGHTING</div><div>flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones</div></div><div><div>MOOD</div><div>envious, public</div></div><div><div>ACTION</div><div>scrolling the feed</div></div></div> |

**082**

BEAT

**06:55**

3.7s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“With pictures. Theo and Jenna buy a house at twenty-five.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** Theo Jenna

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Theo and Jenna standing proudly in front of a small house with a "SOLD" sign in the yard. Character notes: Theo is a stocky bearded man with tired eyes in a flannel shirt; Jenna is a warm woman with a long auburn ponytail and a mustard cardigan. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium-wide shot. Lighting: soft warm daylight. Mood: proud, milestone.

**CAMERA**

medium-wide shot

**LIGHTING**

soft warm daylight

**MOOD**

proud, milestone

**ACTION**

holding up the sign

**083**

BEAT

**06:59**

5.6s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“A small one with a red door and a backyard that floods when it rains.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A backyard with a large muddy puddle spreading across the grass in the rain. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide shot. Lighting: cool rainy light. Mood: foreshadowing.

**CAMERA**

wide shot

**LIGHTING**

cool rainy light

**MOOD**

foreshadowing

**ACTION**

rain pooling in the yard

**084**

BEAT

**07:04**

3.7s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“The group chat fills with paint swatches. Then a puppy.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A phone group chat filled with paint swatch photos and then a photo of a fluffy puppy. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones. Mood: cheerful, domestic.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones

**MOOD**

cheerful, domestic

**ACTION**

new photos popping in

**085**

BEAT

**07:08**

4.8s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Then a photo of keys in Jenna's hand, a ribbon tied around them.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** Jenna

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Close-up photo on a phone of a house key in Jenna's hand tied with a red ribbon. Character notes: Jenna is a warm woman with a long auburn ponytail and a mustard cardigan. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones. Mood: celebratory.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones

**MOOD**

celebratory

**ACTION**

the key photo appearing

**086**

BEAT

**07:13**

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Someone writes, adults. Thirty hearts follow. Marcus moves again. A higher floor.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A group chat message reading "adults" followed by a cascade of thirty heart reactions. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones. Mood: validating, social.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones

**MOOD**

validating, social

**ACTION**

hearts piling up

**087**

BEAT

**07:17**

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“A gym in the basement. A doorman who learns his name. His rent climbs to \$2,100.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Marcus**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A uniformed doorman greeting Marcus by name in a marble lobby, a rent notice in Marcus's hand reading "\$2,100". Character notes: Marcus is a tall, stylish man in his late twenties with a neat fade haircut, a confident grin and a cream linen shirt; the doorman is an older man in a burgundy uniform and cap. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: status, expensive.

**CAMERA**

medium two-shot

**LIGHTING**

soft clean daylight

**MOOD**status,  
expensive**ACTION**

the doorman tipping his hat

**088**

BEAT

**07:23**

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“He mentions it the way people mention the price of a watch. Your updates get smaller.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Marcus** **Theo** **Jenna** **Priya**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Marcus casually showing off a luxury wristwatch while mentioning his rent, friends nodding. Character notes: Marcus is a tall, stylish man in his late twenties with a neat fade haircut, a confident grin and a cream linen shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: braggish.

**CAMERA**

medium shot

**LIGHTING**

soft clean daylight

**MOOD**

braggish

**ACTION**

tapping his watch

**089**

BEAT

**07:29**

5.6s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Then they stop. What are you going to post? A photo of your mother's meatloaf?”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist (younger)**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The younger protagonist's phone showing his own social profile with an empty feed and a blinking cursor. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars. Mood: invisible.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars

**MOOD**

invisible

**ACTION**

the cursor blinking

**090**

BEAT

**07:35**

4.1s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“The ceiling? You go on a date. Her name is Alana.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist (younger)** **Alana**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A casual restaurant date, the younger protagonist seated across from Alana at a small table with candles. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Alana is a lively woman with curly black hair and a rust-colored sweater. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm candle light. Mood: hopeful.

**CAMERA**

medium two-shot

**LIGHTING**

warm candle light

**MOOD**

hopeful

**ACTION**

both smiling over menus

**091**

BEAT

**07:39**

4.8s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“She’s funny and quick, and she likes the same terrible movie you do.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist (younger)** **Alana**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Alana laughing at a joke, the younger protagonist almost smiling, a movie poster on the restaurant wall. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Alana is a lively woman with curly black hair and a rust-colored sweater. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm candle light. Mood: easy chemistry.

**CAMERA**

medium two-shot

**LIGHTING**

warm candle light

**MOOD**

easy chemistry

**ACTION**

laughing together

**092**

BEAT

**07:44**

4.8s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Halfway through dinner she asks where you live. You tell her the truth.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist (younger)** **Alana**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Alana leaning in with a curious question, the younger protagonist answering honestly. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Alana is a lively woman with curly black hair and a rust-colored sweater. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm candle light. Mood: honest, risky.

**CAMERA**

medium two-shot

**LIGHTING**

warm candle light

**MOOD**

honest, risky

**ACTION**

talking over dinner

**093**

BEAT

**07:48**

5.6s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“She says, oh. Just that. Oh. Her face doesn't change much. It just closes, gently,”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** Alana**IMAGE PROMPT**

Alana's polite smile freezing, a tiny speech bubble reading "Oh.". Character notes: Alana is a lively woman with curly black hair and a rust-colored sweater. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up on Alana. Lighting: warm candle light. Mood: cooling.

**CAMERA**

close-up on Alana

**LIGHTING**

warm candle light

**MOOD**

cooling

**ACTION**

her smile stiffening

**094**

BEAT

**07:54**

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“like a door being shut so it won't wake anyone. When the check comes,”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)**IMAGE PROMPT**

A visual metaphor of a door being gently closed in a dark hallway. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: dim hallway light. Mood: soft finality.

**CAMERA**

medium shot

**LIGHTING**

dim hallway light

**MOOD**

soft finality

**ACTION**

the door clicking shut

**095**

BEAT

**07:59**

5.6s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“she reaches for her half before you can reach for all of it. Not rude.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist (younger) Alana**IMAGE PROMPT**

Alana quickly sliding her card into the check folder before the younger protagonist can reach for it. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Alana is a lively woman with curly black hair and a rust-colored sweater. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up on hands. Lighting: warm candle light. Mood: efficient, distant.

**CAMERA**

close-up on hands

**LIGHTING**

warm candle light

**MOOD**

efficient, distant

**ACTION**

her card going in first

**096**

BEAT

**08:05**

5.6s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Efficient. You're being placed in a category, and the category doesn't get a second date.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist (younger)** **Alana**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Alana waving a polite goodbye on the sidewalk while walking away, the younger protagonist standing alone. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Alana is a lively woman with curly black hair and a rust-colored sweater. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium-wide shot. Lighting: cool night streetlight. Mood: final, lonely.

| CAMERA           | LIGHTING               | MOOD          | ACTION             |
|------------------|------------------------|---------------|--------------------|
| medium-wide shot | cool night streetlight | final, lonely | Alana walking away |

**097**

BEAT

**08:10**

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“You drive home and park in the same spot in the driveway.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist (younger)** **Mother** **Father**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The younger protagonist's old sedan pulling into his parents' driveway at night, parking in the same spot. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: his parents are a small graying woman in a faded maroon cardigan and a heavysset gray-mustached man in a plaid shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide shot. Lighting: cool night light. Mood: routine, quiet.

| CAMERA    | LIGHTING         | MOOD           | ACTION             |
|-----------|------------------|----------------|--------------------|
| wide shot | cool night light | routine, quiet | the car pulling in |

**098**

BEAT

**08:15**

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Your father's left the porch light on. He always does. The rule runs the entire time.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **No characters (environment or insert shot)**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A warm porch light glowing above the front door of the modest family house at night. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: warm porch light against cool night. Mood: welcoming, steady.

| CAMERA      | LIGHTING                            | MOOD              | ACTION                  |
|-------------|-------------------------------------|-------------------|-------------------------|
| medium shot | warm porch light against cool night | welcoming, steady | the porch light shining |

**099**

BEAT

**08:21**

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Every raise, half disappears into the account. \$1,200 becomes \$1,400. Then \$1,650. You never feel richer.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Three monthly transfer amounts stacking on screen: "\$1,200", "\$1,400", "\$1,650". Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones. Mood: growing quietly.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones

**MOOD**

growing quietly

**ACTION**

the numbers rising

**100**

BEAT

**08:27**

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“You change a number in an app and go back to work. At work,”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist (younger)**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The younger protagonist at an office desk changing a number in a banking app, then turning back to his monitor. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: routine, unremarkable.

**CAMERA**

medium shot

**LIGHTING**

flat cool office fluorescent light

**MOOD**

routine, unremarkable

**ACTION**

tapping and returning to work

**101**

BEAT

**08:32**

6.3s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“the team goes to lunch on Fridays. Everyone talks about rent the way people talk about weather.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Coworkers chatting animatedly about rent with weather-style icons (sun, clouds, rain) floating above them. Character notes: the coworkers are young office workers in business-casual clothes. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium-wide shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: everyday, comparative.

**CAMERA**

medium-wide shot

**LIGHTING**

soft clean daylight

**MOOD**

everyday, comparative

**ACTION**

coworkers talking

**102**

BEAT

**08:38**

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Somebody's landlord raised it \$150. Somebody else found a place with in-unit laundry for only \$1,900.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Coworker****IMAGE PROMPT**

Another coworker excitedly showing an apartment listing "In-unit laundry \$1,900". Character notes: the coworker is a nervous young man in a wrinkled dress shirt and loosened tie. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: excited.

| CAMERA      | LIGHTING            | MOOD    | ACTION                 |
|-------------|---------------------|---------|------------------------|
| medium shot | soft clean daylight | excited | holding up the listing |

**103**

BEAT

**08:44**

5.6s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Your manager, Greg, a nice man with three kids and a boat he never uses,”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Greg****IMAGE PROMPT**

A small thought bubble above Greg showing three kids and an unused boat under a tarp. Character notes: Greg is a friendly balding middle-aged manager in a tucked-in navy polo. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot with thought bubble. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: wholesome, suburban.

| CAMERA                          | LIGHTING            | MOOD                | ACTION         |
|---------------------------------|---------------------|---------------------|----------------|
| medium shot with thought bubble | soft clean daylight | wholesome, suburban | Greg chuckling |

**104**

BEAT

**08:50**

3.3s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“turns to you. And where are you these days?”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist (younger)** **Greg****IMAGE PROMPT**

Greg turning toward the younger protagonist with a friendly question. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Greg is a friendly balding middle-aged manager in a tucked-in navy polo. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: curious.

| CAMERA          | LIGHTING            | MOOD    | ACTION             |
|-----------------|---------------------|---------|--------------------|
| medium two-shot | soft clean daylight | curious | leaning toward him |

**105**

BEAT

**08:53**

4.8s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“You say you're at home for now. He nods slowly. At your review,”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist (younger)** **Greg**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Greg nodding slowly with a sympathetic look while the younger protagonist answers. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Greg is a friendly balding middle-aged manager in a tucked-in navy polo. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: polite pity.

| CAMERA          | LIGHTING            | MOOD        | ACTION  |
|-----------------|---------------------|-------------|---------|
| medium two-shot | soft clean daylight | polite pity | nodding |

**106**

BEAT

**08:58**

5.6s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“he gives you the biggest raise on the team. He says it's for your work.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Greg**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A performance review meeting in a glass office, Greg handing over a document reading "Raise: Top of team". Character notes: Greg is a friendly balding middle-aged manager in a tucked-in navy polo. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: rewarding.

| CAMERA          | LIGHTING                           | MOOD      | ACTION            |
|-----------------|------------------------------------|-----------|-------------------|
| medium two-shot | flat cool office fluorescent light | rewarding | handing the paper |

**107**

BEAT

**09:03**

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Then he adds, quietly, maybe this helps you get your own place.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Greg**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Greg leaning in and speaking quietly with a hopeful expression, a thought bubble showing a little apartment. Character notes: Greg is a friendly balding middle-aged manager in a tucked-in navy polo. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: kind, assuming.

| CAMERA          | LIGHTING                           | MOOD           | ACTION     |
|-----------------|------------------------------------|----------------|------------|
| medium two-shot | flat cool office fluorescent light | kind, assuming | leaning in |

**108**

BEAT

**09:08**

3.7s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“He means well. He thinks he's paying for your escape.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist (younger)** **Greg**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Greg patting the younger protagonist's shoulder with a warm, hopeful smile. The younger protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a plain black hoodie with the hood up, thinner and more tired, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Greg is a friendly balding middle-aged manager in a tucked-in navy polo. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: well-meaning.

| CAMERA          | LIGHTING                           | MOOD         | ACTION           |
|-----------------|------------------------------------|--------------|------------------|
| medium two-shot | flat cool office fluorescent light | well-meaning | the shoulder pat |

**109**

BEAT

**09:11**

4.8s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“He doesn't know half of it will be in the account by Monday.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Phone screen on Monday morning showing half the raise transferring to "Investment Account".

Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: flat cool lamp light, washed-out blue-gray tones. Mood: quiet, secret.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

flat cool lamp light, washed-out  
blue-gray tones

**MOOD**

quiet, secret

**ACTION**

the transfer completing

STAGE 5 OF 11

# The Loft and the Mortgage

Age 25 · The pen, the envelope, the \$800

Beats 110-143 · 34 images  
09:16 – 12:07

STAGE NOTES

|                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>110</div> <div>BEAT</div> <div>09:16</div> <div>4.4s</div> <div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Image</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Animated</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Placed</div></div> | <div>“Two things happen in those years that you won't understand until later.”</div> <div>CHARACTERS IN THIS BEATThe Protagonist</div> <div>IMAGE PROMPT</div> <div>The protagonist sitting on his childhood bed looking up at the plastic stars, two small question-mark icons above him. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars. Mood: foreshadowing.</div> <div><div>CAMERA</div><div>medium shot</div><div>LIGHTING</div><div>dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars</div><div>MOOD</div><div>foreshadowing</div><div>ACTION</div><div>looking up</div></div> |
| <div>111</div> <div>BEAT</div> <div>09:21</div> <div>4.8s</div> <div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Image</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Animated</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Placed</div></div> | <div>“The first is an apartment. You're twenty-five and you're tired of explaining yourself.”</div> <div>CHARACTERS IN THIS BEATThe Protagonist</div> <div>IMAGE PROMPT</div> <div>The protagonist walking alone down a downtown sidewalk with a tired, worn-out expression. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium tracking-style shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: weary.</div> <div><div>CAMERA</div><div>medium tracking-style shot</div><div>LIGHTING</div><div>soft clean daylight</div><div>MOOD</div><div>weary</div><div>ACTION</div><div>walking toward the building</div></div>                                                                                                      |

## 112

BEAT

09:25

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“So you go look at a loft downtown. Brick walls. Tall windows.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT **The Protagonist**

## IMAGE PROMPT

A sunlit downtown loft with exposed brick walls and tall factory windows, the protagonist standing in the middle. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide one-point-perspective shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: aspirational.

## CAMERA

wide  
one-point-perspective  
shot

## LIGHTING

soft clean daylight

## MOOD

aspirational

## ACTION

looking around

## 113

BEAT

09:30

5.6s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“A kitchen with a gas stove and a little shelf for spices you don't own.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT **No characters (environment or insert shot)**

## IMAGE PROMPT

An empty wooden spice shelf on the loft kitchen wall beside a sign reading "\$1,650/mo". Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: tempting, hollow.

## CAMERA

close-up insert

## LIGHTING

soft clean daylight

## MOOD

tempting, hollow

## ACTION

the empty shelf

## 114

BEAT

09:35

4.8s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“\$1,650 a month. You can afford it. That's the problem. It isn't reckless.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT **The Protagonist**

## IMAGE PROMPT

The protagonist holding a paycheck stub next to the "\$1,650" listing, both balanced on a scale. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: conflicted.

## CAMERA

medium shot

## LIGHTING

soft clean daylight

## MOOD

conflicted

## ACTION

weighing the papers

## 115

BEAT

09:40

3.7s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“It's just more. The leasing agent is about your age.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** [The Protagonist](#) [The Leasing Agent](#)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A leasing office with a glass desk, the leasing agent smiling across from the protagonist. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: the leasing agent is a polished young woman in a fitted gray blazer. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: professional, persuasive.

**CAMERA**

medium two-shot

**LIGHTING**

soft clean daylight

**MOOD**professional,  
persuasive**ACTION**

the agent greeting him

## 116

BEAT

09:44

4.1s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“She's wearing a blazer and she's very good at her job.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** [The Leasing Agent](#)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The leasing agent confidently presenting a glossy brochure. Character notes: the leasing agent is a polished young woman in a fitted gray blazer. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot on the leasing agent. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: polished, persuasive.

**CAMERA**medium shot on the  
leasing agent**LIGHTING**

soft clean daylight

**MOOD**polished,  
persuasive**ACTION**

presenting the brochure

## 117

BEAT

09:48

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“She slides the lease across a glass desk and sets a pen on top of it.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** [The Leasing Agent](#)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The leasing agent sliding a lease contract across a glass desk. Character notes: the leasing agent is a polished young woman in a fitted gray blazer. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up on the desk. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: decisive.

**CAMERA**

close-up on the desk

**LIGHTING**

soft clean daylight

**MOOD**

decisive

**ACTION**

the lease sliding forward

## 118

BEAT

09:54

4.8s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Everything about the room says, you belong here. You pick up the pen.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** [The Protagonist](#)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist picking up the pen in the stylish office, motivational wall art reading "Welcome Home" behind him. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: tempted.

**CAMERA**

medium shot

**LIGHTING**

soft clean daylight

**MOOD**

tempted

**ACTION**

lifting the pen

**119**

BEAT

**09:59**

6.3s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“And you stand there long enough that she starts to smile less. You put the pen down.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist** **The Leasing Agent**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist frozen with the pen hovering over the signature line, the leasing agent's smile slowly fading. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: the leasing agent is a polished young woman in a fitted gray blazer. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: tense, hesitant.

| CAMERA          | LIGHTING            | MOOD            | ACTION           |
|-----------------|---------------------|-----------------|------------------|
| medium two-shot | soft clean daylight | tense, hesitant | hovering the pen |

**120**

BEAT

**10:05**

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“You say you need to think. She says the unit won't last. You say you understand.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist** **The Leasing Agent**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The leasing agent warning with a raised finger while the protagonist nods calmly and stands to leave. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: the leasing agent is a polished young woman in a fitted gray blazer. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: pressure resisted.

| CAMERA          | LIGHTING            | MOOD              | ACTION      |
|-----------------|---------------------|-------------------|-------------|
| medium two-shot | soft clean daylight | pressure resisted | standing up |

**121**

BEAT

**10:11**

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“That night the group chat lights up. Marcus on his balcony. City behind him.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Marcus**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A phone screen at night showing a group chat photo of Marcus posing on his balcony. Character notes: Marcus is a tall, stylish man in his late twenties with a neat fade haircut, a confident grin and a cream linen shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars. Mood: envious.

| CAMERA          | LIGHTING                                                                       | MOOD    | ACTION              |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|---------------------|
| close-up insert | dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars | envious | the photo appearing |

**122**

BEAT

**10:16**

4.8s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“A caption with three fire emojis. And you lie under thirty-one plastic stars,”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist lying on his childhood bed staring up at thirty-one glowing plastic stars. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: high-angle shot. Lighting: dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars. Mood: lonely, reflective.

**CAMERA**

high-angle shot

**LIGHTING**

dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars

**MOOD**

lonely, reflective

**ACTION**

lying still

**123**

BEAT

**10:21**

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“wondering if you're building something or just getting very good at hiding from your own life.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist curled under the blanket while faint shadows of a life passing by move across the ceiling. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars. Mood: avoidant, uncertain.

**CAMERA**

medium shot

**LIGHTING**

dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars

**MOOD**

avoidant, uncertain

**ACTION**

pulling the blanket up

**124**

BEAT

**10:27**

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“You don't feel disciplined. You feel behind. Priya is the only one who ever gets close.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist** **Priya**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Priya standing in a doorway looking toward the protagonist with a gentle, perceptive expression. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Priya is a calm, observant woman with dark wavy shoulder-length hair, small gold hoop earrings and an olive jacket. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: warm bar lighting. Mood: observant, caring.

**CAMERA**

medium shot

**LIGHTING**

warm bar lighting

**MOOD**

observant, caring

**ACTION**

watching quietly

**125**

BEAT

**10:33**

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“At a bar that year, she watches you order water with lime”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist Priya

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A busy bar, the protagonist ordering water with lime from a bartender, Priya beside him noticing. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Priya is a calm, observant woman with dark wavy shoulder-length hair, small gold hoop earrings and an olive jacket; the bartender is a tattooed young woman in a black tee. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm bar lighting. Mood: frugal, noticed.

**CAMERA**

medium two-shot

**LIGHTING**

warm bar lighting

**MOOD**

frugal, noticed

**ACTION**

holding the water glass

**126**

BEAT

**10:37**

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“while everyone else orders the second round. She doesn't make a joke about it.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist Marcus Theo Jenna Priya

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Friends ordering a second round of colorful cocktails while the protagonist sips water. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: the friends are Marcus (tall, fade haircut, linen shirt), Theo (stocky, bearded, flannel), Jenna (auburn ponytail, mustard cardigan) and Priya (dark wavy hair, olive jacket). Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium-wide shot. Lighting: warm bar lighting. Mood: contrast.

**CAMERA**

medium-wide shot

**LIGHTING**

warm bar lighting

**MOOD**

contrast

**ACTION**

glasses being refilled

**127**

BEAT

**10:42**

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“She just slides her fries toward the middle of the table, where you can reach them.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** Priya

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Priya sliding a basket of fries toward the center of the table. Character notes: Priya is a calm, observant woman with dark wavy shoulder-length hair, small gold hoop earrings and an olive jacket. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up on the table. Lighting: warm bar lighting. Mood: quiet kindness.

**CAMERA**

close-up on the table

**LIGHTING**

warm bar lighting

**MOOD**

quiet kindness

**ACTION**

sliding the fries

## 128

BEAT

10:48

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Later, in the parking lot, she asks if you're okay for money. Not pity.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist Priya

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A dark parking lot outside the bar, Priya asking a quiet question beside the protagonist's car. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Priya is a calm, observant woman with dark wavy shoulder-length hair, small gold hoop earrings and an olive jacket. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: cool night streetlight. Mood: concerned.

| CAMERA          | LIGHTING               | MOOD      | ACTION                  |
|-----------------|------------------------|-----------|-------------------------|
| medium two-shot | cool night streetlight | concerned | leaning against the car |

## 129

BEAT

10:54

4.8s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Just a question. You tell her you're fine. She looks at your car,”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist Priya

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist replying with a small shrug, Priya listening without judgment. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Priya is a calm, observant woman with dark wavy shoulder-length hair, small gold hoop earrings and an olive jacket. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: cool night streetlight. Mood: honest concern.

| CAMERA          | LIGHTING               | MOOD           | ACTION    |
|-----------------|------------------------|----------------|-----------|
| medium two-shot | cool night streetlight | honest concern | shrugging |

## 130

BEAT

10:58

3.7s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“then at you, and says, okay. She doesn't believe you.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist Priya

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Priya glancing at the protagonist's old dented sedan and then back at him. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Priya is a calm, observant woman with dark wavy shoulder-length hair, small gold hoop earrings and an olive jacket. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: cool night streetlight. Mood: skeptical, kind.

| CAMERA          | LIGHTING               | MOOD            | ACTION             |
|-----------------|------------------------|-----------------|--------------------|
| medium two-shot | cool night streetlight | skeptical, kind | looking at the car |

**131**

BEAT

**11:02**

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“She just decides not to push. You'll think about that parking lot for years.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The empty parking lot under a single streetlight after everyone has left. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide shot. Lighting: cool night streetlight. Mood: memorable, quiet.

**CAMERA**

wide shot

**LIGHTING**

cool night streetlight

**MOOD**memorable,  
quiet**ACTION**

the lot sitting empty

**132**

BEAT

**11:07**

4.8s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“The second thing, you almost miss. Your father's hours get cut. Not fired.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Father**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

His father in a worn work jacket staring at a work schedule with hours crossed out. Character notes: his father is a heavyset man in his sixties with a gray mustache and a worn plaid shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: flat cool light. Mood: worried pride.

**CAMERA**

medium shot

**LIGHTING**

flat cool light

**MOOD**

worried pride

**ACTION**

staring at the schedule

**133**

BEAT

**11:12**

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Just cut. Thirty hours a week instead of forty. Your parents don't tell you.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A weekly schedule sheet with forty hours crossed out and "30 HRS" written in red. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: flat cool light. Mood: financial strain.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

flat cool light

**MOOD**

financial strain

**ACTION**

the red marks

**134**

BEAT

**11:17**

4.8s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“You find out from the envelope on the counter with the bank's logo,”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

An envelope with a bank logo lying on a kitchen counter, the protagonist picking it up. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: warm overhead kitchen light. Mood: discovery.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

warm overhead kitchen light

**MOOD**

discovery

**ACTION**

lifting the envelope

**135**

BEAT

**11:22**

6.3s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“opened and refolded too many times. The mortgage. \$1,180 a month. Eleven years left. You don't ask.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A mortgage statement creased from being folded many times, showing "\$1,180/month". Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: warm overhead kitchen light. Mood: heavy.

| CAMERA          | LIGHTING                    | MOOD  | ACTION              |
|-----------------|-----------------------------|-------|---------------------|
| close-up insert | warm overhead kitchen light | heavy | the creases visible |

**136**

BEAT

**11:28**

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“You just change one number. Starting that month, \$800 goes to your parents instead of \$500.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A banking app screen changing a transfer from "\$500" to "\$800" labeled "Parents". Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: soft clean daylight, neutral tones. Mood: generous, silent.

| CAMERA          | LIGHTING                           | MOOD             | ACTION              |
|-----------------|------------------------------------|------------------|---------------------|
| close-up insert | soft clean daylight, neutral tones | generous, silent | the number changing |

**137**

BEAT

**11:34**

4.8s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“You tell your mother it's because you eat more than you used to.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist** **Mother**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist handing his mother a thicker envelope, smiling awkwardly, a plate of food in his other hand. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: his mother is a small woman in her late fifties with short graying hair, reading glasses on a beaded chain and a faded maroon cardigan. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm overhead kitchen light. Mood: playful excuse.

| CAMERA          | LIGHTING                    | MOOD           | ACTION               |
|-----------------|-----------------------------|----------------|----------------------|
| medium two-shot | warm overhead kitchen light | playful excuse | handing the envelope |

**138**

BEAT

**11:39**

3.7s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“She looks at you a long time. She doesn't argue.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist** **Mother**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

His mother looking at the protagonist for a long silent moment, her eyes softening. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: his mother is a small woman in her late fifties with short graying hair, reading glasses on a beaded chain and a faded maroon cardigan. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up on his mother. Lighting: warm overhead kitchen light. Mood: understanding.

**CAMERA**

close-up on his mother

**LIGHTING**

warm overhead kitchen light

**MOOD**

understanding

**ACTION**

accepting the envelope

**139**

BEAT

**11:43**

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“You don't know it yet, but that \$800 isn't going to groceries.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **No characters (environment or insert shot)**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A grocery bag sitting empty on the counter while the "\$800" envelope slides past it. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: warm overhead kitchen light. Mood: redirected.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

warm overhead kitchen light

**MOOD**

redirected

**ACTION**

the envelope bypassing the groceries

**140**

BEAT

**11:47**

5.6s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Your mother is sending every dollar of it straight to the principal on the house.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Mother**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

His mother at the kitchen table at night filling out a mortgage payment slip with the "\$800" envelope beside it. Character notes: his mother is a small woman in her late fifties with short graying hair, reading glasses on a beaded chain and a faded maroon cardigan. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: dim warm lamp light. Mood: secret devotion.

**CAMERA**

medium shot

**LIGHTING**

dim warm lamp light

**MOOD**

secret devotion

**ACTION**

writing on the slip

**141**

BEAT

**11:53**

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“And for almost four years, the plan doesn't make you feel smart.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist at his desk looking at a calendar with four years crossed out, his expression flat. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: unsatisfied.

**CAMERA**

medium shot

**LIGHTING**

soft clean daylight

**MOOD**

unsatisfied

**ACTION**

staring at the calendar

142

BEAT

11:57

4.8s

☐ Image

☐ Animated

☐ Placed

“It makes everyone else look like they started living years before you did.”

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT

The Protagonist

Marcus

Theo

Jenna

Priya

IMAGE PROMPT

Split frame: friends traveling and celebrating on one side, the protagonist in his childhood bedroom on the other. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: the friends are Marcus (tall, fade haircut, linen shirt), Theo (stocky, bearded, flannel), Jenna (auburn ponytail, mustard cardigan) and Priya (dark wavy hair, olive jacket). Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: split-screen medium shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: left behind.

| CAMERA                   | LIGHTING            | MOOD        | ACTION              |
|--------------------------|---------------------|-------------|---------------------|
| split-screen medium shot | soft clean daylight | left behind | scrolling his phone |

143

BEAT

12:02

5.2s

☐ Image

☐ Animated

☐ Placed

“You have no way of knowing the distance between you is already turning around.”

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT

The Protagonist

Marcus

Theo

Jenna

Priya

IMAGE PROMPT

A scale slowly tipping toward the protagonist's side while friends' side rises, unnoticed by everyone. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: the friends are Marcus (tall, fade haircut, linen shirt), Theo (stocky, bearded, flannel), Jenna (auburn ponytail, mustard cardigan) and Priya (dark wavy hair, olive jacket). Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium metaphorical shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: turning tide.

| CAMERA                   | LIGHTING            | MOOD         | ACTION                       |
|--------------------------|---------------------|--------------|------------------------------|
| medium metaphorical shot | soft clean daylight | turning tide | the scale beginning to shift |

## STAGE 6 OF 11

## The Crash

Age 26 · When fear doesn't get a vote

Beats 144-173 · 30 images

12:07 – 14:34

## STAGE NOTES

144

BEAT

12:07

4.8s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*“You're twenty-six when the market falls apart. Not a dip. A real one.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

## IMAGE PROMPT

A red market crash graph plunging on a TV screen in a family living room. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: cool TV glow in a dim living room. Mood: alarming.

## CAMERA

close-up insert

## LIGHTING

cool TV glow in a dim living room

## MOOD

alarming

## ACTION

the line falling

145

BEAT

12:12

4.4s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*“The kind that leads the evening news in your parents' living room”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Mother** **Father**

## IMAGE PROMPT

His parents' living room with the evening news showing a "MARKET CRASH" headline. Character notes: his parents are a small graying woman in a faded maroon cardigan and a heavyset gray-mustached man in a plaid shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide shot. Lighting: cool TV glow in a dim living room. Mood: anxious.

## CAMERA

wide shot

## LIGHTING

cool TV glow in a dim living room

## MOOD

anxious

## ACTION

the news playing

146

BEAT

12:17

4.8s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*“while your father shakes his head at the screen. Over four bad months,”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist** **Father**

## IMAGE PROMPT

His father in an armchair shaking his head at the television while the protagonist watches from the doorway. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: his father is a heavyset man in his sixties with a gray mustache and a worn plaid shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: cool TV glow in a dim living room. Mood: grim.

## CAMERA

medium shot

## LIGHTING

cool TV glow in a dim living room

## MOOD

grim

## ACTION

shaking his head

**147**

BEAT

**12:21**

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“your account loses twenty-two percent. At work, people say, did you see what the market did?”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Coworkers gathered around a monitor with shocked faces looking at falling stock charts. Character notes: the coworkers are young office workers in business-casual clothes. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium-wide shot. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: panicked.

**CAMERA**

medium-wide shot

**LIGHTING**

flat cool office fluorescent light

**MOOD**

panicked

**ACTION**

pointing at the screen

**148**

BEAT

**12:27**

3.3s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“in the voice you'd use for a car accident.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Coworkers speaking in hushed, grim tones as if discussing a car accident. Character notes: the coworkers are young office workers in business-casual clothes. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: grave.

**CAMERA**

medium shot

**LIGHTING**

flat cool office fluorescent light

**MOOD**

grave

**ACTION**

whispering

**149**

BEAT

**12:31**

5.6s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“A guy two desks over sells everything on a Thursday afternoon and goes home early.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Coworker**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The same coworker grabbing his coat and leaving early, a calendar showing Thursday. Character notes: the coworker is a nervous young man in a wrinkled dress shirt and loosened tie. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: defeated.

**CAMERA**

medium shot

**LIGHTING**

flat cool office fluorescent light

**MOOD**

defeated

**ACTION**

walking out

**150**

BEAT

**12:36**

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“He tells you he's done gambling. You nod. You open the app at work”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Close-up of a phone screen showing a balance dropping from "\$31,000" to "\$24,000". Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: soft clean daylight, neutral tones. Mood: painful, stark.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

soft clean daylight, neutral tones

**MOOD**

painful, stark

**ACTION**

the number falling

## 151

BEAT

12:41

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“and watch \$31,000 turn into \$24,000. That year, you put in more than \$19,000.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Close-up of a phone screen showing a balance dropping from "\$31,000" to "\$24,000". Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: soft clean daylight, neutral tones. Mood: painful, stark.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

soft clean daylight, neutral tones

**MOOD**

painful, stark

**ACTION**

the number falling

## 152

BEAT

12:47

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“And in December the balance is lower than it was in January.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A balance chart comparing December lower than January with a red arrow pointing down. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: soft clean daylight, neutral tones. Mood: frustrating.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

soft clean daylight, neutral tones

**MOOD**

frustrating

**ACTION**

the chart ending lower

## 153

BEAT

12:51

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Theo's house is still standing. Marcus's view is still there. Their choices didn't evaporate.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Marcus** **Theo** **Jenna**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Theo and Jenna's red-door house standing firm, and Marcus's skyline view through a window. Character notes: Marcus is a tall, stylish man in his late twenties with a neat fade haircut, a confident grin and a cream linen shirt; Theo is a stocky bearded man with tired eyes in a flannel shirt; Jenna is a warm woman with a long auburn ponytail and a mustard cardigan. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: split-screen wide shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: stable for others.

**CAMERA**

split-screen wide shot

**LIGHTING**

soft clean daylight

**MOOD**

stable for others

**ACTION**

both scenes calm

## 154

BEAT

12:56

4.1s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Yours look like they did. You want to stop. You don't.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist's finger hovering over a "STOP TRANSFERS" button on his phone. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up over his hand. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: tempted.

**CAMERA**

close-up over his hand

**LIGHTING**

soft clean daylight

**MOOD**

tempted

**ACTION**

hovering

**155**

BEAT

**13:00**

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Not because you're brave. Because the transfer was set up years ago,”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

An old automatic transfer setting dated years ago on a dusty screen. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: soft clean daylight, neutral tones. Mood: automated discipline.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

soft clean daylight, neutral tones

**MOOD**

automated discipline

**ACTION**

the setting locked in

**156**

BEAT

**13:05**

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“back before fear had a vote. It keeps buying while everything is on sale.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A store window with a giant "SALE" banner and small share icons being bought up in a cart. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium metaphorical shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: opportunity.

**CAMERA**

medium metaphorical shot

**LIGHTING**

soft clean daylight

**MOOD**

opportunity

**ACTION**

shares going into the cart

**157**

BEAT

**13:10**

4.1s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“You just can't feel that yet. It only feels like losing.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist staring at his phone with a downcast expression. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: discouraged.

**CAMERA**

close-up

**LIGHTING**

soft clean daylight

**MOOD**

discouraged

**ACTION**

staring blankly

**158**

BEAT

**13:14**

5.6s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“That night you lie under the ceiling and count the stars. Thirty-one. Same as always.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist in bed counting the glowing plastic stars on the ceiling with a slow finger. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: high-angle shot. Lighting: dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars. Mood: steady, lonely.

**CAMERA**

high-angle shot

**LIGHTING**

dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars

**MOOD**

steady, lonely

**ACTION**

pointing at each star

**159**

BEAT

**13:20**

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“They're the only thing in your life that hasn't moved. Somewhere in that stretch,”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Close-up of the unchanged ceiling stars in the same pattern, glowing softly. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars. Mood: constant.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars

**MOOD**

constant

**ACTION**

the stars glowing

**160**

BEAT

**13:25**

6.3s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Marcus gets drinks with you and looks at the blue lanyard hanging out of your jacket pocket.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Close-up of the faded blue lanyard dangling out of the protagonist's jacket pocket. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: warm bar lighting. Mood: nostalgic, noticed.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

warm bar lighting

**MOOD**

nostalgic, noticed

**ACTION**

the lanyard hanging out

**161**

BEAT

**13:31**

4.1s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“You still carry that thing? he says. It's from high school.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Marcus**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Marcus pointing and laughing at the lanyard. Character notes: Marcus is a tall, stylish man in his late twenties with a neat fade haircut, a confident grin and a cream linen shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium close-up on Marcus. Lighting: warm bar lighting. Mood: teasing.

**CAMERA**

medium close-up on Marcus

**LIGHTING**

warm bar lighting

**MOOD**

teasing

**ACTION**

laughing

**162**

BEAT

**13:35**

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Let me buy you a key ring at least. You tell him it's lucky.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Marcus**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Marcus holding up a sleek leather key ring offer. Character notes: Marcus is a tall, stylish man in his late twenties with a neat fade haircut, a confident grin and a cream linen shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: warm bar lighting. Mood: flashy, condescending.

**CAMERA**

medium shot

**LIGHTING**

warm bar lighting

**MOOD**

flashy, condescending

**ACTION**

offering the key ring

## 163

BEAT

13:40

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“He lets it go. Then your car's transmission dies on the highway.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT **The Protagonist**

## IMAGE PROMPT

The protagonist's car stalled on a highway shoulder with hazard lights blinking and smoke rising. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide shot. Lighting: cool overcast daylight. Mood: stressful.

## CAMERA

wide shot

## LIGHTING

cool overcast daylight

## MOOD

stressful

## ACTION

smoke rising from the hood

## 164

BEAT

13:45

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“\$2,300. The kind of bill that would have flattened you at twenty-two.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT **The Protagonist**

## IMAGE PROMPT

A repair estimate reading "Transmission: \$2,300" held in the protagonist's hand. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: cool overcast daylight. Mood: daunting.

## CAMERA

close-up insert

## LIGHTING

cool overcast daylight

## MOOD

daunting

## ACTION

holding the estimate

## 165

BEAT

13:49

6.3s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“You pay it from your checking account standing at the counter of the repair shop. The mechanic,”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT **The Protagonist**

## IMAGE PROMPT

A gritty auto repair shop counter with tools on the wall, the protagonist paying calmly. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: warm shop lighting. Mood: steady.

## CAMERA

medium shot

## LIGHTING

warm shop lighting

## MOOD

steady

## ACTION

standing at the counter

## 166

BEAT

13:55

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“an older man with grease in the creases of his knuckles, waits for you to flinch.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Mechanic**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

An older mechanic with grease-stained knuckles behind the counter, watching closely. Character notes: the mechanic is an older man in blue coveralls with grease-stained knuckles. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot on the mechanic. Lighting: warm shop lighting. Mood: curious.

**CAMERA**

medium shot on the mechanic

**LIGHTING**

warm shop lighting

**MOOD**

curious

**ACTION**

wiping his hands

## 167

BEAT

14:01

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Most people do. You don't. He looks at you a second longer than usual.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist** **The Mechanic**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The mechanic raising an eyebrow, impressed, as the protagonist pockets his card. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: the mechanic is an older man in blue coveralls with grease-stained knuckles. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up on the mechanic. Lighting: warm shop lighting. Mood: respectful.

**CAMERA**

close-up on the mechanic

**LIGHTING**

warm shop lighting

**MOOD**

respectful

**ACTION**

raising an eyebrow

## 168

BEAT

14:07

4.8s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“You're three steps into the parking lot before you realize you weren't afraid.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist walking across the repair shop parking lot, pausing mid-step with a dawning realization. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: surprised calm.

**CAMERA**

medium shot

**LIGHTING**

soft clean daylight

**MOOD**

surprised calm

**ACTION**

stopping mid-step

## 169

BEAT

14:11

3.7s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“The fear just wasn't there. Somewhere in the boring years,”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist standing relaxed with no sweat drops or worry lines, a broken chain lying at his feet. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium metaphorical shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: freed.

| CAMERA                   | LIGHTING            | MOOD  | ACTION         |
|--------------------------|---------------------|-------|----------------|
| medium metaphorical shot | soft clean daylight | freed | standing still |

## 170

BEAT

14:15

4.8s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“without a date you could circle, it left. By twenty-seven, the market turns.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A pale ghost of fear drifting away from the protagonist over a montage of ordinary workdays. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium metaphorical shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: quiet transformation.

| CAMERA                   | LIGHTING            | MOOD                 | ACTION           |
|--------------------------|---------------------|----------------------|------------------|
| medium metaphorical shot | soft clean daylight | quiet transformation | the ghost fading |

## 171

BEAT

14:20

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“The shares you bought in the fire start doing what shares do.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Tiny share icons sprouting into small green plants inside a glass box. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up metaphor. Lighting: soft clean daylight, neutral tones. Mood: growth.

| CAMERA            | LIGHTING                           | MOOD   | ACTION           |
|-------------------|------------------------------------|--------|------------------|
| close-up metaphor | soft clean daylight, neutral tones | growth | plants sprouting |

## 172

BEAT

14:24

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“The account doesn't just recover. It passes everything it was before. \$80,000.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

An investment balance on a phone reading "\$80,000" with a green recovery graph. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: soft clean daylight, neutral tones. Mood: rewarding.

| CAMERA          | LIGHTING                           | MOOD      | ACTION              |
|-----------------|------------------------------------|-----------|---------------------|
| close-up insert | soft clean daylight, neutral tones | rewarding | the number climbing |

173

BEAT

14:29

5.6s

☐ Image

☐ Animated

☐ Placed

“Then \$100,000 on an ordinary Wednesday. You notice it the way you'd notice the weather.”

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT

The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT

The protagonist glancing at his phone and then looking out a window at the weather with the same flat expression. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: nonchalant.

| CAMERA      | LIGHTING            | MOOD       | ACTION           |
|-------------|---------------------|------------|------------------|
| medium shot | soft clean daylight | nonchalant | glancing outside |

STAGE 7 OF 11

The Reversal

Age 27 · Lives that have to be fed

Beats 174-194 · 21 images  
14:34 – 16:14

STAGE NOTES

|                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>174</div> <div>BEAT</div> <div>14:34</div> <div>3.7s</div> <div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Image</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Animated</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Placed</div></div> | <div>“And around that time, the reversal starts. Quiet. Invisible. Real.”</div> <div>CHARACTERS IN THIS BEATThe ProtagonistMarcusTheoJennaPriya</div> <div>IMAGE PROMPT</div> <div>A seesaw slowly tipping in the protagonist's favor while friends' side sinks. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: the friends are Marcus (tall, fade haircut, linen shirt), Theo (stocky, bearded, flannel), Jenna (auburn ponytail, mustard cardigan) and Priya (dark wavy hair, olive jacket). Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium metaphorical shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: turning point.</div> <div><div>CAMERAmedium metaphorical shot</div><div>LIGHTINGsoft clean daylight</div><div>MOODturning point</div><div>ACTIONthe seesaw tipping</div></div> |
| <div>175</div> <div>BEAT</div> <div>14:38</div> <div>4.4s</div> <div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Image</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Animated</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Placed</div></div> | <div>“Theo and Jenna's interest rate resets. Their payment jumps \$640 a month.”</div> <div>CHARACTERS IN THIS BEATTheoJenna</div> <div>IMAGE PROMPT</div> <div>Theo and Jenna at their kitchen table staring at a letter reading "New payment: +\$640/mo". Character notes: Theo is a stocky bearded man with tired eyes in a flannel shirt; Jenna is a warm woman with a long auburn ponytail and a mustard cardigan. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: stressed.</div> <div><div>CAMERAmedium two-shot</div><div>LIGHTINGsoft clean daylight</div><div>MOODstressed</div><div>ACTIONholding the letter</div></div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <div>176</div> <div>BEAT</div> <div>14:42</div> <div>4.8s</div> <div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Image</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Animated</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Placed</div></div> | <div>“The same number as Kyle's truck. You notice it. You don't say it.”</div> <div>CHARACTERS IN THIS BEATCousin Kyle</div> <div>IMAGE PROMPT</div> <div>Split frame: the "+\$640" mortgage letter beside Cousin Kyle's "\$640/mo" truck photo. Character notes: Cousin Kyle is a broad young man in a trucker cap and a team jersey. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: split-screen close-up. Lighting: soft clean daylight, neutral tones. Mood: ironic parallel.</div> <div><div>CAMERAsplit-screen close-up</div><div>LIGHTINGsoft clean daylight, neutral tones</div><div>MOODironic parallel</div><div>ACTIONboth numbers matching</div></div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |

**177**

BEAT

**14:47**

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Then the basement floods, the one that always flooded, and this time it's \$9,000.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** Theo Jenna

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Theo and Jenna's basement flooding, water rising over boxes and a washing machine. Character notes: Theo is a stocky bearded man with tired eyes in a flannel shirt; Jenna is a warm woman with a long auburn ponytail and a mustard cardigan. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide shot. Lighting: cool dim basement light. Mood: disaster.

**CAMERA**

wide shot

**LIGHTING**

cool dim basement light

**MOOD**

disaster

**ACTION**

water rising

**178**

BEAT

**14:52**

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Jenna mentions it at dinner like it's a joke. Theo doesn't laugh.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** Theo Jenna

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Jenna laughing nervously at a dinner table while Theo stares down at his plate, unsmiling. Character notes: Theo is a stocky bearded man with tired eyes in a flannel shirt; Jenna is a warm woman with a long auburn ponytail and a mustard cardigan. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm dining light. Mood: strained.

**CAMERA**

medium two-shot

**LIGHTING**

warm dining light

**MOOD**

strained

**ACTION**

Jenna forcing a laugh

**179**

BEAT

**14:57**

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“They've been paying for five years and the bank still owns most of the red door.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** Theo Jenna

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The red front door of Theo and Jenna's house with a large bank logo shadow cast over most of it. Character notes: Theo is a stocky bearded man with tired eyes in a flannel shirt; Jenna is a warm woman with a long auburn ponytail and a mustard cardigan. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium metaphorical shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: ironic ownership.

**CAMERA**

medium metaphorical shot

**LIGHTING**

soft clean daylight

**MOOD**

ironic ownership

**ACTION**

the shadow covering the door

**180**

BEAT

**15:03**

5.6s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“At their Fourth of July barbecue, Theo stands at the grill a little too long”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** Theo

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Theo standing alone at the grill with a spatula, staring blankly at the smoke. Character notes: Theo is a stocky bearded man with tired eyes in a flannel shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot on Theo. Lighting: bright summer daylight. Mood: preoccupied.

**CAMERA**

medium shot on Theo

**LIGHTING**

bright summer daylight

**MOOD**

preoccupied

**ACTION**

staring at the grill

## 181

BEAT

15:08

3.7s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“after the burgers are done. He tells you they refinanced.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist Theo

## IMAGE PROMPT

Theo confiding in the protagonist beside the grill, finished burgers piled on a plate. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Theo is a stocky bearded man with tired eyes in a flannel shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: bright summer daylight. Mood: confessional.

## CAMERA

medium two-shot

## LIGHTING

bright summer daylight

## MOOD

confessional

## ACTION

Theo lowering his voice

## 182

BEAT

15:12

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Stretched it back out to thirty years to make the payment work.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

## IMAGE PROMPT

Close-up of refinance paperwork reading "Term: 30 years" on a patio table. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: bright summer daylight. Mood: resigned.

## CAMERA

close-up insert

## LIGHTING

bright summer daylight

## MOOD

resigned

## ACTION

the paper flapping in the breeze

## 183

BEAT

15:17

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“We'll own it when we're sixty-two, he says, and flips a burger that doesn't need flipping.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** Theo

## IMAGE PROMPT

Theo forcing a grin with a thought bubble showing an old man with a cane standing by the red door. Character notes: Theo is a stocky bearded man with tired eyes in a flannel shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot with thought bubble. Lighting: bright summer daylight. Mood: wry, sad.

## CAMERA

medium shot with thought bubble

## LIGHTING

bright summer daylight

## MOOD

wry, sad

## ACTION

grinning

## 184

BEAT

15:22

4.1s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“He laughs. You laugh. Neither of you means it. Behind him,”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist Theo

## IMAGE PROMPT

Theo and the protagonist both going quiet, their smiles fading. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Theo is a stocky bearded man with tired eyes in a flannel shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: bright summer daylight. Mood: heavy, unspoken.

## CAMERA

medium two-shot

## LIGHTING

bright summer daylight

## MOOD

heavy, unspoken

## ACTION

staring at the grill

## 185

BEAT

15:27

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“the backyard is still soft from the last flood. Marcus's rent goes to \$2,900.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** Theo

## IMAGE PROMPT

The soggy, muddy backyard behind Theo with lawn chairs sinking into the soft ground. Character notes: Theo is a stocky bearded man with tired eyes in a flannel shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide shot. Lighting: bright summer daylight. Mood: lingering damage.

## CAMERA

wide shot

## LIGHTING

bright summer daylight

## MOOD

lingering  
damage

## ACTION

chairs sinking slightly

## 186

BEAT

15:32

4.1s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“He gets a letter slid under his door about the renewal.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** Marcus

## IMAGE PROMPT

An envelope slid under a sleek apartment door, Marcus picking it up. Character notes: Marcus is a tall, stylish man in his late twenties with a neat fade haircut, a confident grin and a cream linen shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: uneasy.

## CAMERA

medium shot

## LIGHTING

soft clean daylight

## MOOD

uneasy

## ACTION

bending to pick it up

## 187

BEAT

15:36

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“He shows it to you on his phone and says, it's fine, it's fine,”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist Marcus

## IMAGE PROMPT

Marcus showing the protagonist the notice on his phone at a café table. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Marcus is a tall, stylish man in his late twenties with a neat fade haircut, a confident grin and a cream linen shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: forced calm.

## CAMERA

medium two-shot

## LIGHTING

soft clean daylight

## MOOD

forced calm

## ACTION

holding out the phone

## 188

BEAT

15:41

4.8s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“the way people say it when it isn't. Four years in that building.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** Marcus

## IMAGE PROMPT

Marcus waving it off with an uneasy grin, a small sweat drop on his forehead. Character notes: Marcus is a tall, stylish man in his late twenties with a neat fade haircut, a confident grin and a cream linen shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up on Marcus. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: denial.

## CAMERA

close-up on Marcus

## LIGHTING

soft clean daylight

## MOOD

denial

## ACTION

waving his hand

**189**

BEAT

**15:46**

5.6s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“You do the math in your head without meaning to. More than \$110,000 in rent.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist staring into the distance with small mental math figures floating around his head. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: calculating.

**CAMERA**

close-up

**LIGHTING**

soft clean daylight

**MOOD**

calculating

**ACTION**

doing math silently

**190**

BEAT

**15:51**

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Every dollar of it paying down a stranger's mortgage. He owns the linen shirts.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Rent checks flowing into a stranger landlord's mortgage chute. Character notes: the landlord is a smug middle-aged man in an expensive suit. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: metaphorical wide shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight, neutral tones. Mood: ironic.

**CAMERA**

metaphorical wide shot

**LIGHTING**

soft clean daylight, neutral tones

**MOOD**

ironic

**ACTION**

money flowing away

**191**

BEAT

**15:57**

3.7s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“He owns the watch. He doesn't own a single brick.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Marcus**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A brick wall with a "NOT YOURS" sign hanging on it beside Marcus. Character notes: Marcus is a tall, stylish man in his late twenties with a neat fade haircut, a confident grin and a cream linen shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium metaphorical shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: hollow.

**CAMERA**

medium metaphorical shot

**LIGHTING**

soft clean daylight

**MOOD**

hollow

**ACTION**

Marcus leaning on the wall

**192**

BEAT

**16:00**

4.8s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“And the landlord he's never met just bought a second building. Nobody failed.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A smiling landlord in a suit shaking hands over a "SOLD" sign on a second apartment building. Character notes: the landlord is a smug middle-aged man in an expensive suit. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: ironic success.

**CAMERA**

medium shot

**LIGHTING**

soft clean daylight

**MOOD**

ironic success

**ACTION**

shaking hands

|                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>193</div> <div>BEAT</div> <div>16:05</div> <div>5.2s</div> <div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Image</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Animated</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Placed</div></div> | <div><div>“That's the part that matters. They just built lives that have to be fed.”</div><div>CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT <div>Marcus</div> <div>Theo</div> <div>Jenna</div> <div>Priya</div></div><div>IMAGE PROMPT</div><div>Houses, cars and apartments drawn as hungry creatures with open mouths beside the friends. Character notes: the friends are Marcus (tall, fade haircut, linen shirt), Theo (stocky, bearded, flannel), Jenna (auburn ponytail, mustard cardigan) and Priya (dark wavy hair, olive jacket). Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: metaphorical medium shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: draining.</div><div><div>CAMERA</div><div>metaphorical medium shot</div><div>LIGHTING</div><div>soft clean daylight</div><div>MOOD</div><div>draining</div><div>ACTION</div><div>the creatures waiting to be fed</div></div></div> |
| <div>194</div> <div>BEAT</div> <div>16:10</div> <div>3.7s</div> <div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Image</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Animated</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Placed</div></div> | <div><div>“And the feeding never stops. Yours, quietly, started feeding you.”</div><div>CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)</div><div>IMAGE PROMPT</div><div>Bills feeding endlessly into a hungry slot machine. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up metaphor. Lighting: soft clean daylight, neutral tones. Mood: endless.</div><div><div>CAMERA</div><div>close-up metaphor</div><div>LIGHTING</div><div>soft clean daylight, neutral tones</div><div>MOOD</div><div>endless</div><div>ACTION</div><div>bills flowing in</div></div></div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |

STAGE 8 OF 11

The Nine Seconds

Age 28 · What the rent money really bought

Beats 195–214 · 20 images  
16:14 – 17:58

STAGE NOTES

|                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>195</div> <div>BEAT</div> <div>16:14</div> <div>4.1s</div> <div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Image</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Animated</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Placed</div></div> | <div><p>“You’re twenty-eight when you read a line on a statement twice.”</p></div> <div><div>CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT</div><div>The Protagonist</div></div> <div><div>IMAGE PROMPT</div><div>The protagonist reading a paper statement twice at the kitchen table, eyebrows slightly raised. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: soft warm daylight, gentle shadows. Mood: surprised.</div></div> <div><div><div>CAMERA</div><div>medium shot</div></div><div><div>LIGHTING</div><div>soft warm daylight, gentle shadows</div></div><div><div>MOOD</div><div>surprised</div></div><div><div>ACTION</div><div>reading closely</div></div></div> |
| <div>196</div> <div>BEAT</div> <div>16:18</div> <div>5.2s</div> <div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Image</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Animated</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Placed</div></div> | <div><p>“Before a single new deposit, your account grew \$14,000 that year on its own.”</p></div> <div><div>CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT</div><div>No characters (environment or insert shot)</div></div> <div><div>IMAGE PROMPT</div><div>A statement line reading "Growth this year: +\$14,000" glowing on the page. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: soft warm daylight, gentle shadows. Mood: passive reward.</div></div> <div><div><div>CAMERA</div><div>close-up insert</div></div><div><div>LIGHTING</div><div>soft warm daylight, gentle shadows</div></div><div><div>MOOD</div><div>passive reward</div></div><div><div>ACTION</div><div>the number glowing</div></div></div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <div>197</div> <div>BEAT</div> <div>16:23</div> <div>3.3s</div> <div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Image</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Animated</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Placed</div></div> | <div><p>“While you worked. While you slept under the stars.”</p></div> <div><div>CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT</div><div>No characters (environment or insert shot)</div></div> <div><div>IMAGE PROMPT</div><div>A statement line reading "Growth this year: +\$14,000" glowing on the page. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: soft warm daylight, gentle shadows. Mood: passive reward.</div></div> <div><div><div>CAMERA</div><div>close-up insert</div></div><div><div>LIGHTING</div><div>soft warm daylight, gentle shadows</div></div><div><div>MOOD</div><div>passive reward</div></div><div><div>ACTION</div><div>the number glowing</div></div></div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |

## 198

BEAT

16:27

6.3s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“While you sat at the kitchen table listening to your father complain about the neighbor's leaf blower.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT **Father**

## IMAGE PROMPT

His father complaining while pointing out the window at a neighbor with a loud leaf blower. Character notes: his father is a heavyset man in his sixties with a gray mustache and a worn plaid shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm overhead kitchen light. Mood: humorous, domestic.

## CAMERA

medium two-shot

## LIGHTING

warm overhead kitchen light

## MOOD

humorous,  
domestic

## ACTION

pointing outside

## 199

BEAT

16:33

5.6s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Your salary is still the bigger number. But it isn't the only one working anymore.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT **No characters (environment or insert shot)**

## IMAGE PROMPT

A second income stream drawn as a flowing river joining the main river. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: metaphorical wide shot. Lighting: soft warm daylight, gentle shadows. Mood: compounding.

## CAMERA

metaphorical wide shot

## LIGHTING

soft warm daylight, gentle shadows

## MOOD

compounding

## ACTION

the rivers merging

## 200

BEAT

16:38

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“That same winter, your father slips on the back steps carrying groceries.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT **Father**

## IMAGE PROMPT

His father slipping on icy back steps while carrying grocery bags, groceries flying. Character notes: his father is a heavyset man in his sixties with a gray mustache and a worn plaid shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide shot. Lighting: cold winter daylight. Mood: sudden, painful.

## CAMERA

wide shot

## LIGHTING

cold winter daylight

## MOOD

sudden, painful

## ACTION

falling backward

## 201

BEAT

16:43

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“A broken hip. Surgery. Eight weeks of recovery. Your mother can't lift him alone.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT **Father**

## IMAGE PROMPT

A hospital bed with his father in a hip brace, a surgery schedule on the wall. Character notes: his father is a heavyset man in his sixties with a gray mustache and a worn plaid shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: cool hospital light. Mood: serious.

## CAMERA

medium shot

## LIGHTING

cool hospital light

## MOOD

serious

## ACTION

lying in bed

## 202

BEAT

16:48

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“And you're there. Not because you rearranged your life. Because you never left it.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT **The Protagonist**

## IMAGE PROMPT

The protagonist appearing at the bottom of the stairs, ready to help. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: soft warm daylight, gentle shadows. Mood: present, dependable.

## CAMERA

medium shot

## LIGHTING

soft warm daylight, gentle shadows

## MOOD

present,  
dependable

## ACTION

stepping forward

## 203

BEAT

16:53

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“You hear him fall from upstairs. You're at the bottom of the steps in nine seconds.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT **The Protagonist**

## IMAGE PROMPT

The protagonist rushing down the stairs, a stopwatch overlay reading "0:09". The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium tracking-style shot. Lighting: soft warm daylight, gentle shadows. Mood: urgent.

## CAMERA

medium tracking-style  
shot

## LIGHTING

soft warm daylight, gentle shadows

## MOOD

urgent

## ACTION

running down the stairs

## 204

BEAT

16:59

5.6s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“You drive him to the hospital in your repaired car. Every morning for eight weeks,”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT **The Protagonist** **Father**

## IMAGE PROMPT

The protagonist driving the repaired sedan with his father in the passenger seat wincing. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: his father is a heavyset man in his sixties with a gray mustache and a worn plaid shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot inside the car. Lighting: cold winter daylight. Mood: urgent, caring.

## CAMERA

medium two-shot inside  
the car

## LIGHTING

cold winter daylight

## MOOD

urgent, caring

## ACTION

gripping the wheel

## 205

BEAT

17:05

6.3s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“you help him from the bed to the chair before work. Every night, you help him back.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist** **Father**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist helping his father from a bed into an armchair in the early morning. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: his father is a heavysset man in his sixties with a gray mustache and a worn plaid shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: cool early-morning light. Mood: caring, steady.

**CAMERA**

medium two-shot

**LIGHTING**

cool early-morning light

**MOOD**

caring, steady

**ACTION**

lifting under his arm

## 206

BEAT

17:11

5.6s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“The money you didn't spend on rent bought something you didn't know you were buying.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist holding a gift box labeled "PRESENCE" instead of keys to a loft. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium metaphorical shot. Lighting: soft warm daylight, gentle shadows. Mood: unexpected value.

**CAMERA**

medium metaphorical shot

**LIGHTING**

soft warm daylight, gentle shadows

**MOOD**

unexpected value

**ACTION**

holding the gift

## 207

BEAT

17:17

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Being in the house when it mattered. That's the first time the whole strange arrangement feels”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist at the window of his childhood bedroom, a soft smile almost appearing. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up. Lighting: soft warm daylight, gentle shadows. Mood: quiet realization.

**CAMERA**

close-up

**LIGHTING**

soft warm daylight, gentle shadows

**MOOD**

quiet realization

**ACTION**

looking outside

## 208

BEAT

17:22

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“like it was worth it. Not the balance. The nine seconds. One night during his recovery,”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A scale with a bank balance on one side and a stopwatch reading "0:09" on the other, the stopwatch side heavier. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up metaphor. Lighting: soft warm daylight, gentle shadows. Mood: meaningful.

**CAMERA**

close-up metaphor

**LIGHTING**

soft warm daylight, gentle shadows

**MOOD**

meaningful

**ACTION**

the stopwatch side tipping down

## 209

BEAT

17:28

6.3s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“your mother sits across from you at the kitchen table with a pencil and the mortgage statement.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist Mother

**IMAGE PROMPT**

His mother sitting down across from the protagonist at the kitchen table. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: his mother is a small woman in her late fifties with short graying hair, reading glasses on a beaded chain and a faded maroon cardigan. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: dim warm lamp light. Mood: intimate.

**CAMERA**

medium two-shot

**LIGHTING**

dim warm lamp light

**MOOD**

intimate

**ACTION**

sitting down

## 210

BEAT

17:35

4.1s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“She doesn't hide it this time. She slides it over. Look,”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** Mother

**IMAGE PROMPT**

His mother laying a pencil and the mortgage statement openly on the table. Character notes: his mother is a small woman in her late fifties with short graying hair, reading glasses on a beaded chain and a faded maroon cardigan. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: dim warm lamp light. Mood: open, trusting.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

dim warm lamp light

**MOOD**

open, trusting

**ACTION**

placing them down

## 211

BEAT

17:39

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“she says. And she taps a number she's circled. Twenty-two payments left.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** Mother

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Close-up of his mother's finger tapping a circled number reading "22 payments left". Character notes: his mother is a small woman in her late fifties with short graying hair, reading glasses on a beaded chain and a faded maroon cardigan. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: extreme close-up insert. Lighting: dim warm lamp light. Mood: emotional, proud.

**CAMERA**

extreme close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

dim warm lamp light

**MOOD**

emotional, proud

**ACTION**

tapping the circle

**212**

BEAT

**17:43**

6.3s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“It was supposed to be eight more years. She doesn't say thank you. She doesn't have to.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Mother****IMAGE PROMPT**

His mother looking down at the statement, eyes glistening, saying nothing. Character notes: his mother is a small woman in her late fifties with short graying hair, reading glasses on a beaded chain and a faded maroon cardigan. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up on his mother. Lighting: dim warm lamp light. Mood: grateful, unspoken.

**CAMERA**

close-up on his mother

**LIGHTING**

dim warm lamp light

**MOOD**grateful,  
unspoken**ACTION**

eyes lowered

**213**

BEAT

**17:50**

5.6s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“She just keeps her finger on the number a little longer than she needs to,”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Mother****IMAGE PROMPT**

His mother's finger resting firmly on the circled number. Character notes: his mother is a small woman in her late fifties with short graying hair, reading glasses on a beaded chain and a faded maroon cardigan. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: extreme close-up insert. Lighting: dim warm lamp light. Mood: tender.

**CAMERA**

extreme close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

dim warm lamp light

**MOOD**

tender

**ACTION**

finger pressing down

**214**

BEAT

**17:55**

3.0s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“like it might move if she lets go.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Mother****IMAGE PROMPT**

His mother's finger guarding the number as if holding it in place. Character notes: his mother is a small woman in her late fifties with short graying hair, reading glasses on a beaded chain and a faded maroon cardigan. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: extreme close-up insert. Lighting: dim warm lamp light. Mood: fragile hope.

**CAMERA**

extreme close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

dim warm lamp light

**MOOD**

fragile hope

**ACTION**

not letting go

STAGE 9 OF 11

The Cost of Silence

Age 29 · When the secret becomes a wall

Beats 215–240 · 26 images  
17:58 – 20:11

STAGE NOTES

215

BEAT

17:58

4.8s

☐ Image

☐ Animated

☐ Placed

“But something else starts happening too. Something you don't like. Your mother's friends”

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT

The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT

The protagonist frowning slightly as a gray storm cloud forms faintly above the house. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: soft warm daylight. Mood: unease.

| CAMERA      | LIGHTING           | MOOD   | ACTION   |
|-------------|--------------------|--------|----------|
| medium shot | soft warm daylight | unease | frowning |

216

BEAT

18:03

5.9s

☐ Image

☐ Animated

☐ Placed

“from church ask her about you. You can hear her through the kitchen wall one Sunday.”

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT

The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT

The protagonist in the hallway with his ear near the kitchen wall, listening. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: soft warm daylight. Mood: eavesdropping.

| CAMERA      | LIGHTING           | MOOD          | ACTION    |
|-------------|--------------------|---------------|-----------|
| medium shot | soft warm daylight | eavesdropping | listening |

217

BEAT

18:09

4.8s

☐ Image

☐ Animated

☐ Placed

“He's figuring it out, she says. He's a late bloomer. He'll be fine.”

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT

Mother

IMAGE PROMPT

His mother on the phone in the kitchen, smiling bravely while speaking. Character notes: his mother is a small woman in her late fifties with short graying hair, reading glasses on a beaded chain and a faded maroon cardigan. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: warm overhead kitchen light. Mood: defensive, loving.

| CAMERA      | LIGHTING                    | MOOD              | ACTION               |
|-------------|-----------------------------|-------------------|----------------------|
| medium shot | warm overhead kitchen light | defensive, loving | talking on the phone |

**218**

BEAT

**18:14**

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Her voice is the one she uses to defend things. And she's defending you.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Mother**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Close-up of his mother's determined face mid-sentence. Character notes: his mother is a small woman in her late fifties with short graying hair, reading glasses on a beaded chain and a faded maroon cardigan. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: tight close-up. Lighting: warm overhead kitchen light. Mood: protective.

**CAMERA**

tight close-up

**LIGHTING**

warm overhead kitchen light

**MOOD**

protective

**ACTION**

speaking firmly

**219**

BEAT

**18:19**

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Because she doesn't know about the account. Nobody does. You could walk in and end it.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist** **Mother**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

His mother standing like a shield in front of a small silhouette of the protagonist. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: his mother is a small woman in her late fifties with short graying hair, reading glasses on a beaded chain and a faded maroon cardigan. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: metaphorical medium shot. Lighting: warm overhead kitchen light. Mood: loyal, unaware.

**CAMERA**

metaphorical medium shot

**LIGHTING**

warm overhead kitchen light

**MOOD**

loyal, unaware

**ACTION**

holding up a shield

**220**

BEAT

**18:25**

4.8s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“One sentence. You stand in the hallway with your hand on the wall.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist standing frozen in the hallway, one hand pressed flat against the wall. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: soft warm daylight, gentle shadows. Mood: torn.

**CAMERA**

medium shot

**LIGHTING**

soft warm daylight, gentle shadows

**MOOD**

torn

**ACTION**

standing still

**221**

BEAT

**18:30**

3.7s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Then you go back upstairs. You never chose to lie.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist****IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist walking back up the stairs to his bedroom. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium-wide shot. Lighting: soft warm daylight, gentle shadows. Mood: retreating.

| CAMERA           | LIGHTING                           | MOOD       | ACTION              |
|------------------|------------------------------------|------------|---------------------|
| medium-wide shot | soft warm daylight, gentle shadows | retreating | climbing the stairs |

**222**

BEAT

**18:33**

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“You just never corrected anyone. And at some point those became the same thing.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)**IMAGE PROMPT**

Two road signs reading "LYING" and "SILENCE" merging into a single sign. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: metaphorical close-up. Lighting: soft warm daylight, gentle shadows. Mood: uncomfortable truth.

| CAMERA                | LIGHTING                           | MOOD                | ACTION            |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------|---------------------|-------------------|
| metaphorical close-up | soft warm daylight, gentle shadows | uncomfortable truth | the signs merging |

**223**

BEAT

**18:38**

4.8s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Then it gets uglier. Marcus calls one night. He's moving out. Somewhere cheaper.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist** **Marcus****IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist on a phone call in his bedroom, Marcus shown in a split panel packing boxes in his apartment. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Marcus is a tall, stylish man in his late twenties with a neat fade haircut, a confident grin and a cream linen shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: split-screen medium shots. Lighting: dim evening light. Mood: humbling.

| CAMERA                    | LIGHTING          | MOOD     | ACTION              |
|---------------------------|-------------------|----------|---------------------|
| split-screen medium shots | dim evening light | humbling | Marcus taping a box |

**224**

BEAT

**18:43**

4.8s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“He's embarrassed about it, so he makes it about you. Hey, he says,”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Marcus****IMAGE PROMPT**

Marcus pacing in his half-packed apartment with an embarrassed grin. Character notes: Marcus is a tall, stylish man in his late twenties with a neat fade haircut, a confident grin and a cream linen shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot on Marcus. Lighting: dim evening light. Mood: embarrassed.

| CAMERA                | LIGHTING          | MOOD        | ACTION |
|-----------------------|-------------------|-------------|--------|
| medium shot on Marcus | dim evening light | embarrassed | pacing |

**225**

BEAT

**18:48**

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“why don't we get a two-bedroom together? I can cover the deposit.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Marcus****IMAGE PROMPT**

Marcus on the phone gesturing enthusiastically, a thought bubble showing a two-bedroom apartment. Character notes: Marcus is a tall, stylish man in his late twenties with a neat fade haircut, a confident grin and a cream linen shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot with thought bubble. Lighting: dim evening light. Mood: eager.

**CAMERA**

medium shot with  
thought bubble

**LIGHTING**

dim evening light

**MOOD**

eager

**ACTION**

gesturing

**226**

BEAT

**18:52**

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“It'd be good for you. Get you out of there. He's being generous. He's being kind.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Marcus****IMAGE PROMPT**

Marcus with a warm, kind smile on the phone. Character notes: Marcus is a tall, stylish man in his late twenties with a neat fade haircut, a confident grin and a cream linen shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up on Marcus. Lighting: dim evening light. Mood: sincere.

**CAMERA**

close-up on Marcus

**LIGHTING**

dim evening light

**MOOD**

sincere

**ACTION**

smiling

**227**

BEAT

**18:58**

6.3s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“And he's offering to rescue you with money he doesn't have. You could tell him the truth.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Marcus****IMAGE PROMPT**

Marcus offering a life ring made of crumpled bills, a hole in the ring. Character notes: Marcus is a tall, stylish man in his late twenties with a neat fade haircut, a confident grin and a cream linen shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: metaphorical medium shot. Lighting: soft warm daylight, gentle shadows. Mood: ironic.

**CAMERA**

metaphorical medium  
shot

**LIGHTING**

soft warm daylight, gentle shadows

**MOOD**

ironic

**ACTION**

tossing the ring

**228**

BEAT

**19:05**

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“You could pay the whole year's rent on a two-bedroom without blinking.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist****IMAGE PROMPT**

A thought bubble above the protagonist showing him casually paying a full year's rent. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot with thought bubble. Lighting: dim evening light. Mood: hidden capability.

**CAMERA**

medium shot with  
thought bubble

**LIGHTING**

dim evening light

**MOOD**

hidden capability

**ACTION**

imagining paying

**229**

BEAT

**19:09**

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Instead you say, let me think about it. And you let him feel generous.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist on the phone with a neutral expression, saying he'll think about it. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up. Lighting: dim evening light. Mood: evasive.

**CAMERA**

close-up

**LIGHTING**

dim evening light

**MOOD**

evasive

**ACTION**

speaking calmly

**230**

BEAT

**19:14**

5.6s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“And when you hang up, you notice you're smiling. That's the part that scares you.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist lowering the phone, a small unsettling smile on his face. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up. Lighting: dim evening light. Mood: disturbing self-awareness.

**CAMERA**

close-up

**LIGHTING**

dim evening light

**MOOD**disturbing  
self-awareness**ACTION**

smiling faintly

**231**

BEAT

**19:20**

4.8s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“You've started to enjoy it. Being underestimated. The private math at every table.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist catching his own smiling reflection in a dark window and freezing. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: dim evening light. Mood: unsettling.

**CAMERA**

medium shot

**LIGHTING**

dim evening light

**MOOD**

unsettling

**ACTION**

staring at his reflection

**232**

BEAT

**19:25**

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Knowing what nobody knows. You catch yourself guarding the secret, not because you need to anymore,”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist****IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist guarding a small locked chest at the foot of his bed. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: dim evening light. Mood: possessive.

**CAMERA**

medium shot

**LIGHTING**

dim evening light

**MOOD**

possessive

**ACTION**

resting a hand on the chest

**233**

BEAT

**19:31**

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“but because you like who you get to be inside it. And it lands on you,”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist****IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist sitting inside a small glowing secret room, comfortable and alone. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: metaphorical medium shot. Lighting: soft warm daylight, gentle shadows. Mood: seductive isolation.

**CAMERA**

metaphorical medium shot

**LIGHTING**

soft warm daylight, gentle shadows

**MOOD**

seductive isolation

**ACTION**

sitting comfortably

**234**

BEAT

**19:37**

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“lying under the stars. If you need everyone to think you're stuck,”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist** **Marcus** **Theo** **Jenna** **Priya****IMAGE PROMPT**

Marionette strings attached to the protagonist from above, held by shadowy friends' hands. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: the friends are Marcus (tall, fade haircut, linen shirt), Theo (stocky, bearded, flannel), Jenna (auburn ponytail, mustard cardigan) and Priya (dark wavy hair, olive jacket). Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: metaphorical medium shot. Lighting: dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars. Mood: controlled.

**CAMERA**

metaphorical medium shot

**LIGHTING**

dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars

**MOOD**

controlled

**ACTION**

strings tugging

**235**

BEAT

**19:41**

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“their opinion is still running your life. You just flipped the direction.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The marionette strings flipping upside down while still attached. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: metaphorical medium shot. Lighting: dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars. Mood: ironic.

**CAMERA**

metaphorical medium shot

**LIGHTING**

dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars

**MOOD**

ironic

**ACTION**

strings reversing

**236**

BEAT

**19:45**

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“For years, you refused to perform success. And somewhere along the way,”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist rejecting a flashy costume labeled "SUCCESS" on a rack. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: soft warm daylight, gentle shadows. Mood: principled.

**CAMERA**

medium shot

**LIGHTING**

soft warm daylight, gentle shadows

**MOOD**

principled

**ACTION**

pushing it away

**237**

BEAT

**19:50**

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“you started performing failure just as hard. Priya texts you the next morning. Out of nowhere.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist** **Priya**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist's phone lighting up with a text from Priya on his nightstand at sunrise. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Priya is a calm, observant woman with dark wavy shoulder-length hair, small gold hoop earrings and an olive jacket. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: cool early-morning light. Mood: caring.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

cool early-morning light

**MOOD**

caring

**ACTION**

the phone lighting up

**238**

BEAT

**19:56**

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“You okay? You've seemed far away lately. You start typing the truth. The rule.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist typing a long reply on his phone in bed. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up over his hand. Lighting: cool early-morning light. Mood: vulnerable.

| CAMERA                 | LIGHTING                 | MOOD       | ACTION         |
|------------------------|--------------------------|------------|----------------|
| close-up over his hand | cool early-morning light | vulnerable | typing quickly |

**239**

BEAT

**20:01**

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“The number. Eight years of it. You look at it for a long time.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist staring at the long unsent message on his screen. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up. Lighting: cool early-morning light. Mood: hesitant.

| CAMERA   | LIGHTING                 | MOOD     | ACTION  |
|----------|--------------------------|----------|---------|
| close-up | cool early-morning light | hesitant | staring |

**240**

BEAT

**20:06**

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Then you delete it and send a photo of your mother's meatloaf.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist deleting the message and sending a photo of meatloaf instead. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: cool early-morning light. Mood: deflecting.

| CAMERA          | LIGHTING                 | MOOD       | ACTION       |
|-----------------|--------------------------|------------|--------------|
| close-up insert | cool early-morning light | deflecting | tapping send |

STAGE 10 OF 11

Back on the Rooftop

Age 30 · Paid in full

Beats 241-268 · 28 images  
20:11 – 22:24

STAGE NOTES

|                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>241</div> <div>BEAT</div> <div>20:11</div> <div>4.4s</div> <div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Image</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Animated</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Placed</div></div> | <div>“Which brings you back to the rooftop. Marcus's thirtieth. The heated pool.”</div> <div>CHARACTERS IN THIS BEATThe Protagonist</div> <div>IMAGE PROMPT</div> <div>The protagonist back on the rooftop at night, standing at the railing. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: return to present.</div> <div><div>CAMERA</div><div>medium shot</div><div>LIGHTING</div><div>warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline</div><div>MOOD</div><div>return to present</div><div>ACTION</div><div>standing at the railing</div></div> |
| <div>242</div> <div>BEAT</div> <div>20:15</div> <div>5.2s</div> <div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Image</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Animated</div><div><input type="checkbox"/> Placed</div></div> | <div>“The tablet the waiter never got to hand you. Your phone in your pocket,”</div> <div>CHARACTERS IN THIS BEATThe Waiter</div> <div>IMAGE PROMPT</div> <div>The waiter walking away with the unused payment tablet. Character notes: the waiter is a young man in a black apron. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: unseen.</div> <div><div>CAMERA</div><div>medium shot</div><div>LIGHTING</div><div>warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline</div><div>MOOD</div><div>unseen</div><div>ACTION</div><div>the waiter walking off</div></div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |

**243**

BEAT

**20:20**

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“heavy with one line you haven't shown anyone. Here's what it says.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist**IMAGE PROMPT**

Close-up of the protagonist's hand resting over his jacket pocket with a faintly glowing phone outline. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: heavy secret.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline

**MOOD**

heavy secret

**ACTION**

his hand resting

**244**

BEAT

**20:25**

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“A loan servicing notice. Your parents' mortgage. Final payment received. Balance: \$0.00.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)**IMAGE PROMPT**

Phone screen reading "Final payment received. Balance: \$0.00. PAID IN FULL" with a green check mark. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: extreme close-up insert. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: triumphant.

**CAMERA**

extreme close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline

**MOOD**

triumphant

**ACTION**

the check mark glowing

**245**

BEAT

**20:29**

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Paid in full. Eight years of \$800 envelopes on the kitchen table.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)**IMAGE PROMPT**

Phone screen reading "Final payment received. Balance: \$0.00. PAID IN FULL" with a green check mark. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: extreme close-up insert. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: triumphant.

**CAMERA**

extreme close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline

**MOOD**

triumphant

**ACTION**

the check mark glowing

## 246

BEAT

20:34

5.6s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Every one of them sent to the principal. Eleven years of payments finished in eight.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Envelopes flying into a mortgage document labeled "Principal". Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: metaphorical close-up. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: purposeful.

**CAMERA**

metaphorical close-up

**LIGHTING**

warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline

**MOOD**

purposeful

**ACTION**

envelopes landing

## 247

BEAT

20:39

5.6s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“The house you've been laughed at for living in doesn't belong to the bank anymore.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The modest family house at dusk with laughter speech bubbles floating around it. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide shot. Lighting: warm dusk light. Mood: vindicated.

**CAMERA**

wide shot

**LIGHTING**

warm dusk light

**MOOD**

vindicated

**ACTION**

the house standing

## 248

BEAT

20:45

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“It belongs to the two people who left the porch light on.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Mother** **Father**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

His mother and father on the porch under the warm porch light, smiling softly. Character notes: his mother is a small woman in her late fifties with short graying hair, reading glasses on a beaded chain and a faded maroon cardigan; his father is a heavyset man in his sixties with a gray mustache and a worn plaid shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm porch light against cool dusk. Mood: deserved peace.

**CAMERA**

medium two-shot

**LIGHTING**

warm porch light against cool dusk

**MOOD**

deserved peace

**ACTION**

sitting together

## 249

BEAT

20:49

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“You've been paying a mortgage this whole time. Just not someone else's.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist at the rooftop railing with a calm, quiet smile. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: vindicated.

**CAMERA**

close-up

**LIGHTING**

warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline

**MOOD**

vindicated

**ACTION**

looking out at the city

250

BEAT

20:54

4.1s

☐ Image

☐ Animated

☐ Placed

*“The party thins out after midnight. Theo and Jenna leave first,”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT

No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT

The rooftop party thinning out after midnight, empty glasses on tables. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide shot. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: winding down.

| CAMERA    | LIGHTING                                                                                       | MOOD         | ACTION         |
|-----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|----------------|
| wide shot | warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline | winding down | guests leaving |

251

BEAT

20:58

5.6s

☐ Image

☐ Animated

☐ Placed

*“because their dog has been alone since six. Marcus disappears into a group of coworkers.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT

Theo Jenna

IMAGE PROMPT

Theo and Jenna waving goodbye as they head for the elevator. Character notes: Theo is a stocky bearded man with tired eyes in a flannel shirt; Jenna is a warm woman with a long auburn ponytail and a mustard cardigan. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: tired, warm.

| CAMERA          | LIGHTING                                                                                       | MOOD        | ACTION |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|--------|
| medium two-shot | warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline | tired, warm | waving |

252

BEAT

21:03

3.7s

☐ Image

☐ Animated

☐ Placed

*“And then it's just you and Priya at the railing,”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT

The Protagonist Priya

IMAGE PROMPT

The protagonist and Priya standing alone at the rooftop railing. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Priya is a calm, observant woman with dark wavy shoulder-length hair, small gold hoop earrings and an olive jacket. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: intimate.

| CAMERA          | LIGHTING                                                                                       | MOOD     | ACTION                 |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|------------------------|
| medium two-shot | warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline | intimate | leaning on the railing |

## 253

BEAT

21:07

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“the city spread out below like a circuit board. She doesn't look at you.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The city below glowing like a circuit board of lights. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide shot. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: vast, quiet.

**CAMERA**

wide shot

**LIGHTING**

warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline

**MOOD**

vast, quiet

**ACTION**

the lights glittering

## 254

BEAT

21:12

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“She just says it. So when are you actually moving out? The same question.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** Priya

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Close-up of Priya's speech bubble reading "So when are you actually moving out?". Character notes: Priya is a calm, observant woman with dark wavy shoulder-length hair, small gold hoop earrings and an olive jacket. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: recurring question.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline

**MOOD**

recurring question

**ACTION**

the bubble appearing

## 255

BEAT

21:17

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Eight years later. On a different roof. For eight years, this is where you've said soon.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A stack of speech bubbles reading "soon" piled up beside the protagonist. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: metaphorical medium shot. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: habitual.

**CAMERA**

metaphorical medium shot

**LIGHTING**

warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline

**MOOD**

habitual

**ACTION**

the bubbles stacked

**256**

BEAT

**21:23**

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“This time you take out your phone. You open the account. Not the mortgage.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist taking out his phone and opening an investment app. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: decisive.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline

**MOOD**

decisive

**ACTION**

opening the app

**257**

BEAT

**21:28**

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“The other one. And you set it face up on the railing between you.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist placing his phone face up on the rooftop railing between them. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up on the railing. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: vulnerable.

**CAMERA**

close-up on the railing

**LIGHTING**

warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline

**MOOD**

vulnerable

**ACTION**

setting the phone down

**258**

BEAT

**21:34**

4.8s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“\$214,000. Priya looks at it for a long time. She doesn't say wow.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)**IMAGE PROMPT**

Phone screen showing "\$214,000" in large digits on the rooftop railing. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: extreme close-up insert. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: stunning reveal.

**CAMERA**

extreme close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline

**MOOD**

stunning reveal

**ACTION**

the number glowing

**259**

BEAT

**21:38**

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“She doesn't ask how. She just goes quiet, the way you do”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** Priya**IMAGE PROMPT**

Priya going quiet and still, absorbing it. Character notes: Priya is a calm, observant woman with dark wavy shoulder-length hair, small gold hoop earrings and an olive jacket. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: reflective.

| CAMERA          | LIGHTING                                                                                       | MOOD       | ACTION         |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|----------------|
| medium two-shot | warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline | reflective | standing still |

**260**

BEAT

**21:43**

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“when a story you thought you knew turns out to be a different story.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist Priya**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist and Priya silhouetted at the railing against the glittering city. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Priya is a calm, observant woman with dark wavy shoulder-length hair, small gold hoop earrings and an olive jacket. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide shot. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: reframing.

| CAMERA    | LIGHTING                                                                                       | MOOD      | ACTION          |
|-----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-----------------|
| wide shot | warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline | reframing | silent together |

**261**

BEAT

**21:48**

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“How long? she finally asks. Since the driveway, you say. Since the four boxes.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist**IMAGE PROMPT**

A faded flashback inset of the driveway and four cardboard boxes beside the protagonist. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot with flashback overlay. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: origin.

| CAMERA                             | LIGHTING                                                                                       | MOOD   | ACTION      |
|------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|-------------|
| medium shot with flashback overlay | warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline | origin | remembering |

## 262

BEAT

21:53

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“She asks if your parents know. You tell her about the mortgage.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** The Protagonist Priya Mother Father

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Priya asking about his parents while the protagonist shows the mortgage notice. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Priya is a calm, observant woman with dark wavy shoulder-length hair, small gold hoop earrings and an olive jacket; his parents are a small graying woman in a faded maroon cardigan and a heavysset gray-mustached man in a plaid shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: deepening.

| CAMERA          | LIGHTING                                                                                       | MOOD      | ACTION             |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|--------------------|
| medium two-shot | warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline | deepening | showing the notice |

## 263

BEAT

21:58

3.7s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“About the envelopes. About your mother's finger on the number.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** Mother

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A montage of the envelopes and his mother's finger on the circled number. Character notes: his mother is a small woman in her late fifties with short graying hair, reading glasses on a beaded chain and a faded maroon cardigan. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: two-panel montage. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: emotional.

| CAMERA            | LIGHTING                                                                                       | MOOD      | ACTION                 |
|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|------------------------|
| two-panel montage | warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline | emotional | the memories appearing |

## 264

BEAT

22:01

4.8s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Priya turns back to the city and doesn't say anything for a while.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** Priya

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Priya turning back toward the city, quiet, the night wind lifting her hair. Character notes: Priya is a calm, observant woman with dark wavy shoulder-length hair, small gold hoop earrings and an olive jacket. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: moved.

| CAMERA      | LIGHTING                                                                                       | MOOD  | ACTION      |
|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|-------------|
| medium shot | warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline | moved | looking out |

**265**

BEAT

**22:06**

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Then she says, that's the most grown-up thing anyone on this roof has done.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist** **Priya**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Priya looking at the protagonist with deep respect. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Priya is a calm, observant woman with dark wavy shoulder-length hair, small gold hoop earrings and an olive jacket. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: admiring.

| CAMERA          | LIGHTING                                                                                       | MOOD     | ACTION          |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|-----------------|
| medium two-shot | warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline | admiring | speaking softly |

**266**

BEAT

**22:11**

4.8s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“She laughs once, softly, not at you. We all thought you were stuck,”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Priya**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Priya laughing softly with warmth, not mockery. Character notes: Priya is a calm, observant woman with dark wavy shoulder-length hair, small gold hoop earrings and an olive jacket. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: tender.

| CAMERA          | LIGHTING                                                                                       | MOOD   | ACTION   |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|----------|
| medium two-shot | warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline | tender | laughing |

**267**

BEAT

**22:16**

4.8s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“she says. And you give her the only true thing you have left.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist** **Priya**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist looking at Priya with a vulnerable, open expression. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Priya is a calm, observant woman with dark wavy shoulder-length hair, small gold hoop earrings and an olive jacket. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: honest.

| CAMERA   | LIGHTING                                                                                       | MOOD   | ACTION           |
|----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|------------------|
| close-up | warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline | honest | meeting her eyes |

268

BEAT

22:21

2.6s

☐ Image

☐ Animated

☐ Placed

“For a while, you say. I was.”

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT

The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT

The protagonist answering with a faint, real smile at the railing. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up. Lighting: warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline. Mood: humble truth.

|          |                                                                                                |              |                  |
|----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|------------------|
| CAMERA   | LIGHTING                                                                                       | MOOD         | ACTION           |
| close-up | warm golden string lights and the blue glow of a heated pool against a cool night city skyline | humble truth | speaking quietly |

STAGE 11 OF 11

Moving Out

After · The last star

Beats 269–288 · 20 images  
22:24 – 24:06

STAGE NOTES

269  
BEAT

22:24  
4.8s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

“Three weeks later, you sign for a small house on the east side.”

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT

A cozy brick two-family house on a tree-lined street with a "SOLD" sign. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide shot. Lighting: warm natural light with amber accents. Mood: accomplished.

| CAMERA    | LIGHTING                              | MOOD         | ACTION               |
|-----------|---------------------------------------|--------------|----------------------|
| wide shot | warm natural light with amber accents | accomplished | the sign in the yard |

270  
BEAT

22:28  
4.8s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

“A two-family. You'll live in one half. The other half pays for itself.”

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT

Split view of the two-family house, the protagonist on one side and a tenant family moving in on the other. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: cutaway medium shot. Lighting: warm natural light with amber accents. Mood: smart, stable.

| CAMERA              | LIGHTING                              | MOOD          | ACTION               |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------|---------------|----------------------|
| cutaway medium shot | warm natural light with amber accents | smart, stable | both halves lived in |

271  
BEAT

22:33  
4.4s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

“You put down forty percent. The loan officer reads your file twice,”

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist The Loan Officer

IMAGE PROMPT

A loan office with a middle-aged loan officer reading a thick file across a desk from the protagonist. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: the loan officer is a middle-aged man in a navy suit and striped tie. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm natural light with amber accents. Mood: professional.

| CAMERA          | LIGHTING                              | MOOD         | ACTION           |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------|--------------|------------------|
| medium two-shot | warm natural light with amber accents | professional | reading the file |

**272**

BEAT

**22:38**

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“then looks up at you with a different face than the one he walked in with.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Loan Officer**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The loan officer's expression shifting to respect, eyebrows raised. Character notes: the loan officer is a middle-aged man in a navy suit and striped tie. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up on the loan officer. Lighting: warm natural light with amber accents. Mood: newfound respect.

**CAMERA**

close-up on the loan officer

**LIGHTING**

warm natural light with amber accents

**MOOD**

newfound respect

**ACTION**

adjusting his tie

**273**

BEAT

**22:44**

4.4s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“He'd seen the address on your application. Your parents' address. He'd assumed.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Mother** **Father**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

Close-up of the loan application with the parents' home address highlighted. Character notes: his parents are a small graying woman in a faded maroon cardigan and a heavysset gray-mustached man in a plaid shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: warm natural light with amber accents. Mood: assumption.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

warm natural light with amber accents

**MOOD**

assumption

**ACTION**

the address highlighted

**274**

BEAT

**22:48**

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Now he asks if you'd like coffee. He walks you to the elevator himself.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist** **The Loan Officer**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The loan officer offering the protagonist a cup of coffee with a broad smile. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: the loan officer is a middle-aged man in a navy suit and striped tie. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm natural light with amber accents. Mood: deferential.

**CAMERA**

medium two-shot

**LIGHTING**

warm natural light with amber accents

**MOOD**

deferential

**ACTION**

holding out the coffee

**275**

BEAT

**22:53**

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“He tells you to call his cell, not the office line. Your last night at home,”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Loan Officer**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The loan officer handing over a business card with a handwritten cell number. Character notes: the loan officer is a middle-aged man in a navy suit and striped tie. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: warm natural light with amber accents. Mood: exclusive.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

warm natural light with amber accents

**MOOD**

exclusive

**ACTION**

handing the card

**276**

BEAT

**22:59**

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“you stand on your old bed and peel the stars off the ceiling. One by one.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A handful of peeled stars in his palm, one remaining stuck on the ceiling. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars. Mood: tender.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars

**MOOD**

tender

**ACTION**

the last star clinging

**277**

BEAT

**23:05**

5.6s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Thirty of them come off clean. One won't let go. You leave it there. Downstairs,”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A handful of peeled stars in his palm, one remaining stuck on the ceiling. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars. Mood: tender.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars

**MOOD**

tender

**ACTION**

the last star clinging

**278**

BEAT

**23:11**

5.9s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“your mother is at the kitchen table, holding the spare key on the faded blue lanyard.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Mother**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

His mother holding the spare key on the faded blue lanyard in her hands. Character notes: his mother is a small woman in her late fifties with short graying hair, reading glasses on a beaded chain and a faded maroon cardigan. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: dim warm lamp light. Mood: nostalgic.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

dim warm lamp light

**MOOD**

nostalgic

**ACTION**

holding the key

**279**

BEAT

**23:17**

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“She tries to give it back to you. You close her hand around it.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist** **Mother**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

His mother holding the key out toward the protagonist. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: his mother is a small woman in her late fifties with short graying hair, reading glasses on a beaded chain and a faded maroon cardigan. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: dim warm lamp light. Mood: letting go.

**CAMERA**

medium two-shot

**LIGHTING**

dim warm lamp light

**MOOD**

letting go

**ACTION**

offering the key

**280**

BEAT

**23:22**

4.1s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“Keep it, you tell her. I’ll need it. On the porch,”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist** **Mother**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist smiling softly at his mother across the kitchen table. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: his mother is a small woman in her late fifties with short graying hair, reading glasses on a beaded chain and a faded maroon cardigan. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: dim warm lamp light. Mood: loving.

| CAMERA          | LIGHTING            | MOOD   | ACTION          |
|-----------------|---------------------|--------|-----------------|
| medium two-shot | dim warm lamp light | loving | speaking gently |

**281**

BEAT

**23:26**

6.7s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“your father is sitting in the chair he couldn’t get out of on his own a year ago.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Father**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A faded inset of his father struggling to stand during his hip recovery. Character notes: his father is a heavyset man in his sixties with a gray mustache and a worn plaid shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: split medium shot. Lighting: warm porch light against cool night. Mood: contrast.

| CAMERA            | LIGHTING                            | MOOD     | ACTION             |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------|----------|--------------------|
| split medium shot | warm porch light against cool night | contrast | struggling to rise |

**282**

BEAT

**23:32**

6.3s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“He stands up without help. He shakes your hand like you’re someone he just met and likes.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist** **Father**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

His father shaking the protagonist’s hand warmly on the porch. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: his father is a heavyset man in his sixties with a gray mustache and a worn plaid shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm porch light against cool night. Mood: respect.

| CAMERA          | LIGHTING                            | MOOD    | ACTION        |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------|---------|---------------|
| medium two-shot | warm porch light against cool night | respect | shaking hands |

**283**

BEAT

**23:39**

5.9s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*“Then the porch light comes on behind him. Same as every night. Nobody touched the switch.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Father****IMAGE PROMPT**

The porch light clicking on above his father's head. Character notes: his father is a heavysset man in his sixties with a gray mustache and a worn plaid shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: low-angle medium shot. Lighting: warm porch light against cool night. Mood: constant.

**CAMERA**

low-angle medium shot

**LIGHTING**

warm porch light against cool night

**MOOD**

constant

**ACTION**

the light coming on

**284**

BEAT

**23:45**

4.8s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*“It's on a timer now. He set it the week you moved home.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **Father****IMAGE PROMPT**

A faded flashback inset of his father installing the timer eight years ago. Character notes: his father is a heavysset man in his sixties with a gray mustache and a worn plaid shirt. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot with flashback overlay. Lighting: warm porch light against cool night. Mood: loving.

**CAMERA**

medium shot with flashback overlay

**LIGHTING**

warm porch light against cool night

**MOOD**

loving

**ACTION**

his father screwing in the timer

**285**

BEAT

**23:49**

4.4s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*“It started with a number on a rental app. \$1,700 a month.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **No characters (environment or insert shot)****IMAGE PROMPT**

A phone rental app screen showing "\$1,700/mo" fading into the night sky. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: warm natural light with amber accents. Mood: origin.

**CAMERA**

close-up insert

**LIGHTING**

warm natural light with amber accents

**MOOD**

origin

**ACTION**

the number fading

**286**

BEAT

**23:54**

3.3s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

*“The money changed what you were free to choose.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist****IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist walking toward his new two-family house with a box under his arm. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium-wide shot. Lighting: warm dusk light. Mood: freedom.

**CAMERA**

medium-wide shot

**LIGHTING**

warm dusk light

**MOOD**

freedom

**ACTION**

walking up the path

**287**

BEAT

**23:57**

3.3s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“The silence changed what you were willing to say.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** **The Protagonist**

**IMAGE PROMPT**

The protagonist standing quietly on the new porch, mouth closed, keys in hand. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: warm dusk light. Mood: reserved.

**CAMERA**

medium shot

**LIGHTING**

warm dusk light

**MOOD**

reserved

**ACTION**

standing still

**288**

BEAT

**24:01**

5.2s

- ☐ Image  
☐ Animated  
☐ Placed

*“And the house you were laughed at for living in was never someone else's.”*

**CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT** No characters (environment or insert shot)

**IMAGE PROMPT**

A final close-up of the single plastic star still glowing on the empty bedroom ceiling. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: extreme close-up. Lighting: dim warm bedside lamp light with the faint green glow of plastic ceiling stars. Mood: final, tender.

**CAMERA**

extreme close-up

**LIGHTING**

dim warm bedside lamp light with  
the faint green glow of plastic  
ceiling stars

**MOOD**

final, tender

**ACTION**

the star glowing